

Subjectivity Intersection Ontology: A Comparative Ontological Framework for Third Subjectivity

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Abstract

The relational turn in artificial intelligence and cognitive science has renewed questions not only concerning intelligence and cognition, but also concerning the ontological status of subjectivity itself. Although the possibility that interaction may constitute cognition, meaning, or experience has been widely discussed, the ontological question of whether interaction itself may constitute a new subjectivity irreducible to any of the subjectivities from which it arises has not necessarily been examined explicitly.

This paper presents Subjectivity Intersection Ontology (SIO) as a conceptual proposal addressing this problem. SIO defines subjectivity as perspective and formulates its ontological prototype as a triadic structure comprising Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity. With respect to multiple Relative Subjectivities, it introduces $AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB$ as the canonical operational form. In this structure, an irreducible third subjectivity is constituted through the intersection of two differentiated subjectivities, and this generated third subjectivity acts back upon and reconstitutes the subjectivities from which it arose.

To examine the historical position of SIO, the paper develops a comparative methodology that distinguishes six levels of comparison—vocabulary, concept, structure, ontology, operation, and empirical consequence—and defines six comparative criteria, N1–N6. These criteria are applied to twenty-one comparison targets drawn from ancient Greek philosophy, ancient and classical Indian philosophy, Christian Trinitarian ontology, German Idealism, process ontology, phenomenology, psychoanalysis, cognitive science, and contemporary philosophy of mind.

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The comparison finds that individual structures relevant to SIO are distributed across multiple traditions. Within the comparative set examined, however, no target clearly satisfies all of N1–N5 and integrates them within a single general ontology under N6. This result does not demonstrate the absolute novelty or truth of SIO, its superiority to other ontologies, or the absence of a comparable structure from the history of thought as a whole. It establishes only the limited conclusion that, relative to the specified comparative set, criteria, and interpretations of the literature, SIO cannot be identified as a merely terminological reformulation of any one of the theories examined.

The paper therefore positions SIO not as a completed metaphysical system, but as an ontological research program whose conceptual coherence, formal precision, and empirical discriminability remain to be examined.

Keywords: subjectivity; ontology; subjectivity intersection; intersubjectivity; emergence; comparative philosophy; artificial intelligence; philosophy of mind

1 Introduction

The rapid development of artificial intelligence has brought renewed attention not only to the question of what intelligence is, but also to the more fundamental philosophical question of what subjectivity is (Russell and Norvig 2021).

Developments in large language models, multi-agent systems, social robotics, and social neuroscience have brought into view the limits of understanding intelligence and cognition solely as properties contained within isolated individuals (Wooldridge 2009; Russell and Norvig 2021; Hasson et al. 2012). Across several areas of cognitive science and philosophy of mind, the view that subjects are formed through interaction with others and with their environments has assumed increasing importance (Varela, Thompson, and Rosch 1991; Thompson 2007; De Jaegher, Di Paolo, and Gallagher 2010).

The ontological problem raised by this relational turn, however, has not necessarily been made fully explicit. The claim that interaction may constitute cognition, meaning, or experience is not identical to the claim that a new subjectivity may be constituted through that interaction. The former may explain how existing subjects are transformed through relation. The latter asks whether relation or intersection itself may constitute a further subjectivity irreducible to any of the subjects from which it arises. This second question extends beyond problems of social cognition and intersubjectivity to an ontological problem: in virtue of what, and through what structure, does something exist as a single existent?

Since Descartes, an influential strand of modern philosophical discussion of subjectivity has treated the certainty of the individual thinking subject as an important point of departure. The cogito—formulated in the *Discourse on the Method* as “I think, therefore I am” and recast in the Second Meditation as the certainty that “I am, I exist”—established subjectivity as a foundational problem of modern philosophy (Descartes 1985, 127; Descartes 1984, 17). Subsequent traditions developed this problem in multiple directions through intersubjectivity, embodiment, process, relation, and emergence (Husserl 1960; Schutz 1967; Zahavi 2001; Merleau-Ponty 2012; Rescher 1996; Bedau and Humphreys 2008). This paper does not deny

the importance of asking how an individual subject relates to others. The question addressed here, however, is not limited to relations among human individuals. More generally, it asks whether the intersection of differentiated subjectivities may itself constitute a further irreducible subjectivity. This is not a straightforward extension of modern theories that begin from individual consciousness, but an attempt to reconsider the ontological constitution of subjectivity as such.

Western ontology has often taken monism and dualism as central points of departure while developing diverse accounts of substance, process, generation, relation, and nonduality. Ancient and classical Indian philosophy, Christian Trinitarian ontology, German Idealism, process philosophy, phenomenology, psychoanalysis, and contemporary cognitive science have likewise proposed sophisticated theories concerning subjectivity, difference, relation, third terms, and generation. These traditions have provided important alternatives to accounts of existence as a collection of static and isolated substances. The recognition of triadicity, relationality, or emergence, however, does not by itself establish an ontology in which a third subjectivity is constituted through intersection. Similarity of vocabulary must therefore be distinguished from equivalence of ontological structure.

This paper presents Subjectivity Intersection Ontology (SIO) as a conceptual proposal addressing this problem. SIO is presented neither as a reinterpretation of an existing ontology nor as an empirically established theory. It is first defined as an explicit ontological proposal; its conceptual consequences are then opened to formalization and empirical examination.

SIO defines subjectivity as perspective. In its ontological prototype, Relative Subjectivity is differentiated through the projection of Absolute Subjectivity, and an Intersection Subjectivity irreducible to either emerges in the interval between them. The canonical operational form through which this prototype is extended to multiple Relative Subjectivities is:

$$AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB.$$

Here, A and B are differentiated Relative Subjectivities, while C is the third subjectivity constituted through their constitutive intersection. C is defined not as the sum or average of A and B, shared content, or an external observer's description, but as a subjectivity irreducible to either. C further acts back upon A and B and reconstitutes their modes of existence. This canonical operational form does not replace the ontological prototype consisting of Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity. The relation between the prototype and its operational form is distinguished rigorously in Chapter 2.

This paper addresses three central questions. First, how can SIO be defined in terms of its own ontological structure without being reduced to an established philosophical vocabulary? Second, how can SIO be compared with historical ontologies without conflating vocabulary or conceptual similarity with structural equivalence? Third, within the comparative set examined here, does any theory clearly integrate the following within a single ontology: differentiated subjectivities, constitutive intersection, an irreducible third subjectivity, the reconstitutive action of that subjectivity upon the subjectivities from which it arose, and the general theoretical scope of this structure?

To address these questions, the paper derives six comparative criteria, N1–N6, from the structure of SIO. N1–N5 independently assess the subjective status of the candidate third

term, the direction of generation through intersection, the reconstitution of the originating subjectivities, the ontological status of the candidate third term, and the generality and theoretical scope of the structure. N6 is the conjunction condition assessing whether these criteria are integrated within a single general ontology. The criteria are not a scale for scoring the philosophical value, historical importance, or truth of the theories under comparison. They constitute an SIO-relative framework for assessing criterion-specific structural correspondence with the ontology defined in this paper.

The methodology is applied to twenty-one comparison targets selected from ancient Greek philosophy, ancient and classical Indian philosophy, Christian Trinitarian ontology, German Idealism, process ontology, phenomenology, psychoanalysis, cognitive science, and contemporary philosophy of mind. For each target, the analysis distinguishes textual evidence, interpretive reconstruction within the theory's own terms, and structural assessment under N1–N6. This separation allows disagreements concerning the selection of texts, historical interpretation, and the application of comparative criteria to be examined as problems arising at distinct analytical levels.

The comparison identifies individual structures relevant to SIO in different forms across multiple traditions. Third terms, relational constitution, generation, the transformation of subjectivity, and general ontological scope are distributed across the comparative set rather than concentrated within any single theory. Kashmir Śaivism, Schelling, Hegel, and Nishida exhibit partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction of N6. None of the twenty-one targets examined, however, clearly satisfied all of N1–N5 and integrated them within a single general ontology, as required for clear satisfaction of N6.

This result does not establish the absolute novelty of SIO or its chronological priority in the history of thought. Nor does it demonstrate the truth of SIO, its superiority to other ontologies, or the empirical reality of third subjectivity. The conclusion warranted by this study is restricted to the specified comparative set, evaluative criteria, and interpretations of the literature. Within those limits, SIO cannot be identified as a merely terminological restatement of any one of the theories examined. The paper therefore positions SIO not as a completed metaphysical system, but as an unfinished ontological research program whose conceptual coherence, formal precision, and empirical discriminability remain to be examined.

In addition to its conceptual contribution, this paper has two methodological aims. The first is to make explicit the criteria that often remain implicit in comparative ontology and to distinguish the vocabulary, conceptual, structural, ontological, operational, and empirical levels of comparison. The second is to document the development of the manuscript, comparative assessments, and revision history in a public repository, thereby making available for examination not only the conclusions of the study but also the process through which they were formed. This public record is documentation of the research process, not evidence supporting the conclusions of the paper. Public discussion likewise does not replace formal peer review, but provides a complementary record of the manuscript's development.

The paper aims to present its ontological proposal, comparative method, historical comparison, philosophical examination, and research methodology as a single transparent research program.

The paper proceeds as follows. Chapter 2 defines SIO in its own terms and distinguishes its ontological prototype from its canonical operational form. Chapter 3 establishes the levels

of comparison, N1–N6, and the assessment procedure. Chapter 4 applies this methodology to twenty-one comparison targets and presents textual evidence, interpretive reconstruction, and structural assessment for each case. Chapter 5 integrates the assessments from Chapter 4 without modifying them and formulates the absence of clear structural equivalence within the comparative set as a delimited proposition. Chapter 6 examines the philosophical implications of SIO for subjectivity and objectivity, intersubjectivity, relation, emergence, individuation, temporality, epistemology, and ethics, and develops a research program encompassing formalization, operationalization, empirical discriminability, and conditions of failure. Chapter 7 clarifies the achievements of the study, the limits of its claims, and the final position of SIO. Taken together, these chapters aim to position SIO as an ontological research program that is conceptually explicit, methodologically transparent, and open to empirical examination.

2 Subjectivity Intersection Ontology

2.1 Status of This Chapter

This chapter defines the basic structure of Subjectivity Intersection Ontology (SIO) in its own terms. Its purpose is neither to translate SIO into concepts drawn from existing philosophical traditions nor to discuss its similarities to other ontologies. Historical comparison and philosophical interpretation are reserved for subsequent chapters.

SIO does not reduce subjectivity to individual psychology, cognitive function, or observational error. It treats subjectivity itself as a constituent of ontology. The account presented in this chapter is not an empirically established fact, but an ontological proposition open to comparison, formalization, and future examination.

The definition of SIO proceeds in the following order:

1. triadic self-closure within primordial unity;
2. Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity;
3. projection from Absolute Subjectivity to Relative Subjectivity;
4. the emergence of Intersection Subjectivity in the interval between Absolute Subjectivity and Relative Subjectivity;
5. hierarchical repetition among multiple Relative Subjectivities; and
6. the distinction among ontological propositions, formal representations, and empirical consequences.

These components are related, but they do not belong to the same level. In particular, the ontological prototype consisting of Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity must be distinguished from the operational form $AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB$, which is used in relation to multiple Relative Subjectivities.

2.2 Ontology

In SIO, subjectivity is defined as perspective. Hereafter, the terms “subjectivity” and “perspective” are used synonymously. Accordingly, A, B, and C in this section are all subjectivities—that is, perspectives.

SIO posits one primordial existence. This unity, however, is not a static identity devoid of difference or relation. A single existence may internally contain a perspective A that gives itself to itself, a perspective B that receives itself from itself, and a perspective C that arises as the intersection of A and B.

One existence S

+--- A: the perspective that gives itself to itself

+--- B: the perspective that receives itself from itself

+--- C: the third perspective that closes the intersection of A and B

A, B, and C are not three independently pre-existing entities. They are three mutually irreducible perspectives internal to one existence. SIO therefore does not posit three independent primordial existences; in this limited sense, it adopts monism.

C is not a result externally added after A and B have already been completed. The constitution of A as the giving perspective and B as the receiving perspective already includes the constitution of C, which completes their correspondence as a single relation.

C is therefore both the result of the intersection of A and B and the condition under which that intersection can exist as a unified relation.

A and B constitute C

C constitutes the correspondence between A and B as a single
closure

This interdependence is not a temporal cycle consisting of an antecedent cause and a subsequent effect. It is an ontological closure in which A, B, and C exist simultaneously as a single self-consistent relation.

Through this triadic self-closure, further differences, correspondences, relations, and interactions can arise from a single existence. This dynamic extension does not occur through the external addition of a second entity to an undifferentiated one. It becomes possible through giving, receiving, and their intersection, all of which are internal to one existence.

2.3 Absolute Subjectivity

Absolute Subjectivity is not an observable object. If a third perspective were positioned outside Absolute Subjectivity in order to observe it, Absolute Subjectivity would already have become an object of observation, contrary to its definition.

Absolute Subjectivity is neither an observational point located within the universe nor a hypothetical perspective surveying everything from outside. It is the primordial subjective pole through which phenomena and perspectives can exist.

In this chapter, Absolute Subjectivity is represented by the symbol *S*. This symbol does not transform Absolute Subjectivity itself into an observable object. *S* is a notation used to describe the ontological structure of SIO.

2.4 Relative Subjectivity

Relative Subjectivity is a subjectivity that receives the projection of Absolute Subjectivity and becomes differentiated as a perspective. A single Relative Subjectivity is represented by R ; multiple Relative Subjectivities are distinguished as $R_1, R_2, \dots, R_n$.

Coordinates such as body, location, time, utterance, and action may be assigned to a Relative Subjectivity. These coordinates, however, are not Relative Subjectivity itself. What can be observed are its expressions, traces, position, actions, and records. The subjectivity experiencing the world cannot itself be observed externally as an object.

The following distinctions must therefore be maintained:

Relative Subjectivity $\neq$ the coordinates of Relative Subjectivity
Relative Subjectivity $\neq$ the observable expressions of Relative
Subjectivity

Relative Subjectivity is not identical to Absolute Subjectivity. Each Relative Subjectivity receives a projection of Absolute Subjectivity but experiences it only partially, from its own relative perspective.

2.5 Intersection Subjectivity

Intersection Subjectivity is a subjectivity that emerges in the interval between Absolute Subjectivity and a Relative Subjectivity differentiated through its projection. In the ontological prototype, Intersection Subjectivity is represented by X .

Intersection Subjectivity cannot be reduced to either Absolute Subjectivity or Relative Subjectivity. Nor is it their average, agreement, fusion, or shared part. It is an irreducible third subjective pole that arises when the correspondence between two subjective poles is completed as a single relation.

The constitution of Intersection Subjectivity does not imply a temporal sequence in which two perspectives first intersect and a third subjectivity is subsequently produced in a separate process. The intersection of the perspectives and the constitution of Intersection Subjectivity are simultaneous. Through their intersection, Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity exist as a single integrated structure.

Intersection Subjectivity itself is also unobservable. What may be observed are the consequences accompanying its constitution, including understanding, synchronization, action, meaning, relational change, and co-generation.

2.6 Projection

Let S denote Absolute Subjectivity, R_i a Relative Subjectivity, and π_i a projection. Their relation may be represented as follows:

$$S \xrightarrow{\pi_i} R_i$$

Projection does not mean a mapping between two already observed objects. It represents the structure through which unobservable Absolute Subjectivity appears as a Relative Subjectivity possessing a particular perspective.

Different Relative Subjectivities receive different projections:

$$S \xrightarrow{\pi_1} R_1$$

$$S \xrightarrow{\pi_2} R_2$$

Each Relative Subjectivity receives a projection of Absolute Subjectivity, but lives that projection from a different perspective. This difference does not arise through the introduction of a second primordial entity external to Absolute Subjectivity. It arises through the projection by which differentiated Relative Subjectivities and perspectives are constituted.

Projection indicates the relation from Absolute Subjectivity to Relative Subjectivity and is one component of the ontological prototype consisting of Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity.

2.7 The Ontological Prototype

Let S denote Absolute Subjectivity and R a Relative Subjectivity differentiated through its projection. The ontological prototype of SIO is defined as follows:

When Relative Subjectivity R is differentiated through the projection of Absolute Subjectivity S , an Intersection Subjectivity X , reducible to neither, emerges in the interval between Absolute Subjectivity S and the projected Relative Subjectivity R .

This structure may be represented schematically as follows:

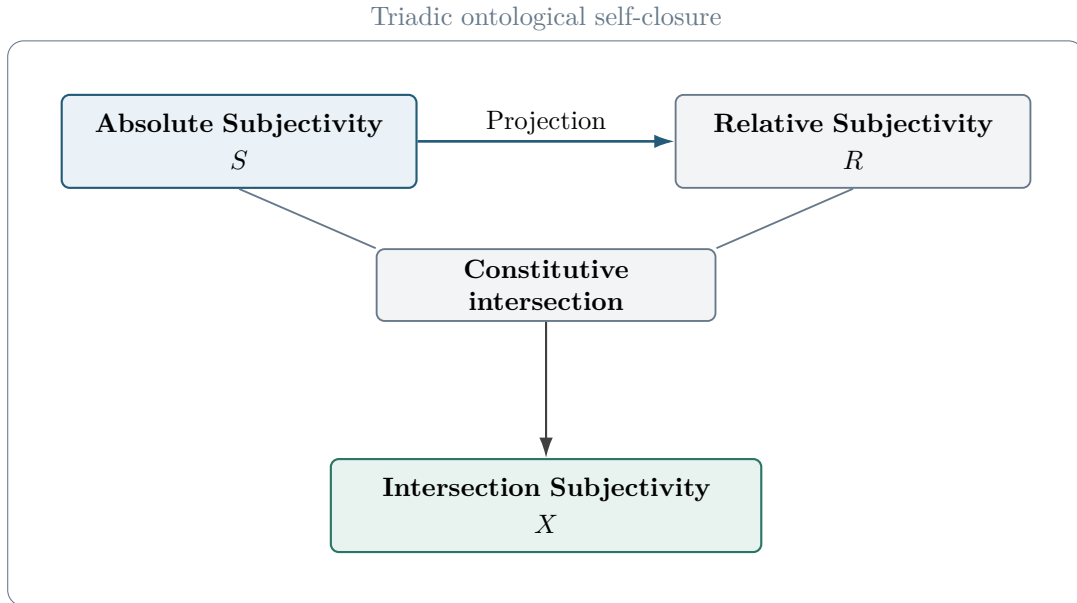


Figure 1. Ontological prototype of Subjectivity Intersection Ontology. Relative Subjectivity R is differentiated through the projection of Absolute Subjectivity S , and Intersection Subjectivity X emerges through the constitutive intersection of S and R . The diagram represents a triadic ontological closure, not a temporal sequence or an empirical mechanism.

This projection is not an event in which a second entity inexplicably proceeds from an undifferentiated one. It expresses the triadic self-closure internal to primordial unity as the relation among Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity.

Absolute Subjectivity as the perspective that gives itself, Relative Subjectivity as the perspective that receives its projection and lives a particular perspective, and Intersection

Subjectivity as the subjectivity that completes their correspondence together form a single ontological structure.

This is not an operational definition in which a third variable is calculated from two already observed objects. It is an ontological definition specifying the relation through which Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity exist.

2.8 Extension to Multiple Subjectivities

Relative Subjectivities R_1 and R_2 , receiving multiple projections of Absolute Subjectivity, possess different perspectives and histories. The constitution of Intersection Subjectivity in the interval between these Relative Subjectivities repeats, at the level of Relative Subjectivity, the ontological prototype in which Intersection Subjectivity emerges between Absolute Subjectivity and Relative Subjectivity.

In the multiple-subjectivity extension, perspective intersection does not occur merely when one Relative Subjectivity apprehends another as an object within its own perspective. SIO calls the change in the standpoint from which the other is apprehended a perspective transformation. Perspective intersection is defined through a transformation in which one Relative Subjectivity views the other from the other's perspective.

$$V_1(R_2) \text{ --perspective transformation--> } V_2(R_2)$$

Let A and B denote two Relative Subjectivities and C the Intersection Subjectivity constituted in their interval. The structure may be abbreviated as follows:

$$AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB$$

This notation does not represent a simple temporal sequence. The constitution of C completes

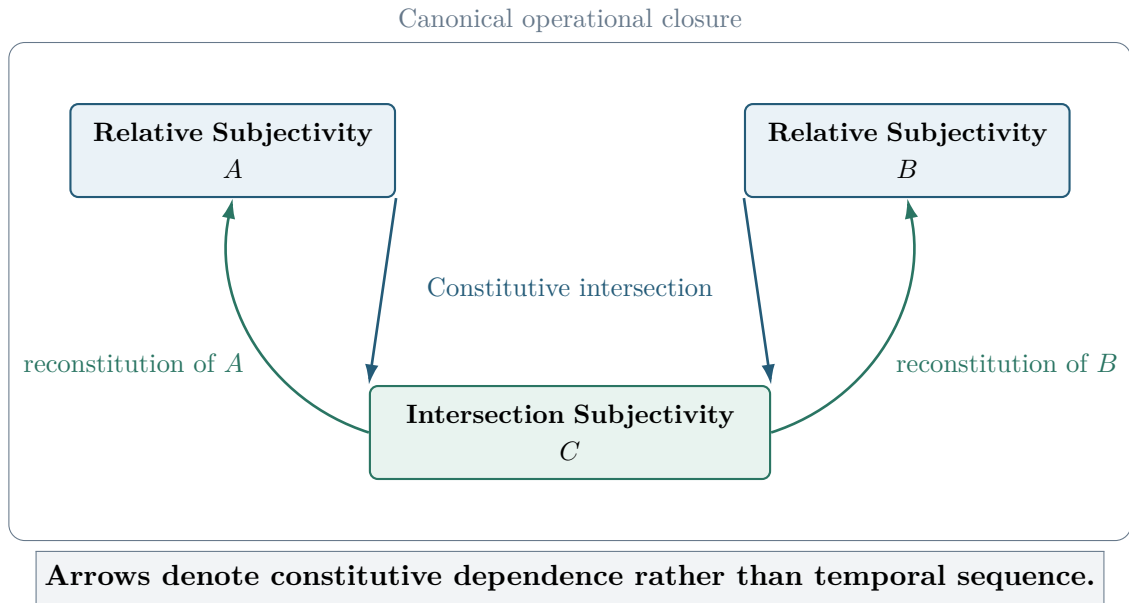


Figure 2. Canonical operational closure among multiple Relative Subjectivities. Relative Subjectivities A and B constitute Intersection Subjectivity C through perspective intersection; C in turn reconstitutes A and B .

the relation between A and B as a whole. Within this relational unity, A , B , and C exist simultaneously.

Intersection Subjectivity C is not a third party added externally to A and B . It is a subjectivity reducible to neither, constituted when the intersection of perspectives completes the relation as a whole.

The constituted Intersection Subjectivity acts upon the perspectives, histories, actions, and interactions of A and B . The initial difference can thereby give rise to new differences, correspondences, relations, and interactions.

$AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB$ is not a definition that replaces the ontological prototype. It is the canonical operational form through which that prototype is represented in relation to multiple Relative Subjectivities.

2.9 Boundary Conditions

To clarify the scope of SIO, the boundary between its ontological claims and observable consequences must be specified.

First, Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity are not themselves objects of observation. What may be observed in relation to Relative Subjectivity includes coordinates, body, utterance, action, records, and expressions. What may be observed in relation to Intersection Subjectivity includes traces of understanding, synchronization, mutual change, co-generation, and relational completion accompanying its constitution.

Subjectivity	Observability	What May Be Observed
Absolute Subjectivity	Unobservable	Structural consequences if projection is assumed
Relative Subjectivity	Subjectivity itself is unobservable	Coordinates, body, utterances, actions, records, expressions
Intersection Subjectivity	Subjectivity itself is unobservable	New understanding, synchronization, mutual change, co-generation, traces of relational completion

Table 1. Ontological observability and possible observable consequences.

Unobservability does not entail non-existence. Nevertheless, unobservable subjectivity itself must be distinguished from the observable consequences predicted to accompany its constitution.

Second, Intersection Subjectivity is not defined as an average, consensus, or fusion of Relative Subjectivities. Nor can it be explained solely as a component shared by them or as one subjectivity's imitation of another. Such phenomena may accompany the constitution of Intersection Subjectivity, but they cannot be identified with Intersection Subjectivity itself.

Third, an observable proxy variable, a mathematical intermediary, or a third node in a computational model is not Intersection Subjectivity itself. These are means of representing the consequences or relational structures predicted if Intersection Subjectivity is constituted.

Fourth, $AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB$ among multiple Relative Subjectivities does not replace the ontological prototype as a whole. The prototype of SIO consists in the projection from Absolute Subjectivity to Relative Subjectivity and the emergence of Intersection Subjectivity in their interval. The multiple-subjectivity form extends this prototype to the level of Relative Subjectivities.

2.10 Distinguishing the Ontological, Formal, and Empirical Levels

At least three levels must be distinguished when discussing SIO.

2.10.1 Ontological Level

The ontological level concerns propositions about the constitution of Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity.

Its central proposition is as follows:

The ontological prototype of subjectivity intersection is that, when Relative Subjectivity is differentiated through the projection of Absolute Subjectivity, an Intersection Subjectivity reducible to neither emerges in the interval between Absolute Subjectivity and the projected Relative Subjectivity.

This is the definition of SIO. It is not a conclusion derived from a mathematical model or empirical result.

2.10.2 Formal Level

The formal level represents projection, perspective transformation, relational completion, and extension to multiple subjectivities through symbols or mathematical structures.

Possible candidates for formalization include projections, perspective transformations, commutative diagrams, operators, simultaneous fixed points, closure, repetition, and holonomy. These mathematical objects, however, are not subjectivities themselves. The role of formalization is to distinguish the structures hypothesized to hold among unobservable subjective poles from their observable consequences and to specify the correspondence between the two.

2.10.3 Empirical Level

The empirical level concerns the observable consequences that would be expected if Intersection Subjectivity were constituted. At least the following elements must be specified separately:

1. **Ontological proposition.** What is assumed concerning Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity.
2. **Operator hypothesis.** How projection, perspective transformation, intersection, and action upon the relation are formally represented.
3. **Observable consequences.** What is measured, including synchronization, mutual prediction, new meaning, co-generation, or simultaneous changes in both participants.
4. **Decision rule.** What results would count as support, non-support, or indeterminacy.

If an appropriate proxy cannot be constructed, the relevant study cannot be regarded as having refuted SIO. The boundary must instead be preserved by classifying the proposition as not presently testable.

These distinctions prevent the success of a mathematical model from being treated as proof of the ontology, an observable third variable from being identified with Intersection Subjectivity itself, or an empirical correlation from being regarded as direct evidence for the existence of subjectivity.

2.11 Summary and Ontological Motivation

The primordial existence posited by SIO is one, but it is not without difference. A single existence internally contains, as a self-consistent structure, a perspective that gives itself to itself, a perspective that receives itself from itself, and a third perspective that is both the result of their intersection and the condition under which that intersection can exist.

This triadic self-closure is expressed as the ontological prototype consisting of Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity:

Absolute Subjectivity S --projection--> Relative Subjectivity R
Intersection Subjectivity X emerges
in the interval between S and R

Subjectivity intersection among multiple Relative Subjectivities repeats this prototype at the level of Relative Subjectivity:

$$AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB$$

Here, *A* and *B* are differentiated Relative Subjectivities, and *C* is the Intersection Subjectivity constituted in their interval. This form does not replace the ontological prototype. It is the canonical operational form for addressing perspectives, histories, interactions, and observable consequences.

SIO defines the intersection of perspectives as constituting a third subjectivity irreducible to the subjectivities from which it emerges. The intersection completes the relation as a whole, from which further differences, correspondences, relations, and interactions can arise.

SIO addresses the question of how unity, difference, and relation can be accounted for within the same ontological structure.

If the unity of primordial existence alone is taken as the starting proposition, a further account is required of how difference arises and why correspondence or relation can exist between differences. Conversely, if multiple independent entities are posited from the outset, the question remains as to why they can enter into relation with one another.

SIO takes neither a temporal transition from one to two nor the external conjunction of two independent entities as its starting point. It proposes as its prototype a triadic self-closure in which one existence simultaneously contains perspective A, which gives itself; perspective B, which receives itself; and perspective C, which completes their intersection. Difference and relation are not added to this structure from outside but are internal to its constitution.

The ontological motivation for introducing SIO is therefore not to reject monism or dualism in general. It is to present an explicit structure capable of describing the constitution of difference while preserving unity and the constitution of relation while preserving difference.

Whether this structure is more adequate than other ontologies, and whether it is historically distinct, cannot be concluded from the definitions presented in this chapter alone. The following chapters therefore evaluate SIO not by redefining its ontology, but by comparing the ontology defined here with existing ontological traditions and by clarifying its relation to possible formal and empirical investigation.

3 Comparative Ontological Methodology

3.1 Why Comparison Requires Methodology

Ontological comparison cannot be conducted simply by identifying shared terms. Across philosophical traditions, the same term may designate different concepts, while different terms may express similar structures. Translation may also create an appearance of lexical agreement even when the underlying ontological assumptions, relations among components, direction of constitution, and understanding of reality differ substantially.

For example, two theories may both emphasize “relation,” yet one may understand relation as an external connection between already existing entities, while the other treats relation as a condition through which the relata themselves are constituted. Similarly, the presence of a “third term” does not establish that the third is a subjectivity, that it is generated through the intersection of two subjectivities, or that it acts back upon the subjectivities from which it originates.

Ontological comparison therefore requires an explicit method for distinguishing lexical agreement, conceptual similarity, structural correspondence, and ontological equivalence. If the criteria remain implicit, judgments of similarity and difference may shift with the selection of comparison cases, terminological translation, or interpretive assumptions.

The methodology developed in this chapter is not proposed as a universal taxonomy of ontologies. It is introduced specifically as a framework for evaluating structural correspondence with Subjectivity Intersection Ontology (SIO).

Nor is this methodology intended to replace historical interpretation with a mechanical procedure. The reconstruction of a theory in its linguistic, historical, and argumentative context remains indispensable. The purpose of this chapter is to make the grounds of the structural judgments that follow such interpretation explicit, transparent, and open to examination.

3.2 The Problem of Superficial Similarity

Ontological comparison is vulnerable to treating lexical resemblance as structural resemblance. Terms such as “triad,” “emergence,” “relation,” “subjectivity,” “unity,” and “generation” occur in diverse philosophical contexts and do not possess uniform meanings.

Not every theory with a triadic structure proposes the same ontology. A third term may be assigned the status of mediation, synthesis, symbol, relation, community, field, process, or observer-dependent description. The mere presence of a third term does not establish that it is an irreducible subjectivity.

Likewise, the use of the term “emergence” does not determine what emerges, from what it emerges, or according to what direction of constitution it arises. The emergent term may be an observer’s descriptive construct, a functional organization, a psychological experience, or a subjectivity treated as ontologically real. These possibilities must be distinguished.

The same applies to relation. A relation that connects already existing terms is not equivalent to a relation through which the terms themselves are constituted. Nor can self, person, consciousness, perspective, epistemic subject, legal subject, and grammatical subject be assumed to possess the same ontological status.

This study therefore rejects the following inferences:

Shared vocabulary → identical concept
 Identical concept → identical structure
 Triadic form → identical ontology
 Functional similarity → identical ontological status
 Similar consequence → identical generative principle

Terminological agreement may provide a starting point for comparison, but it is not itself evidence of structural equivalence. The relevant question is not whether the same words are used, but what constitutes what, which status is assigned to each component, and how the relation as a whole is defined.

3.3 Levels of Comparison

This study distinguishes six levels of ontological comparison. The purpose of this distinction is to prevent similarity at one level from being treated as sufficient evidence of equivalence at another.

3.3.1 Vocabulary

The vocabulary level identifies whether identical or similar terms are used. These may include subjectivity, relation, intersection, third term, generation, emergence, unity, and closure.

Lexical agreement may assist in identifying relevant comparison cases. Because the same word may express different concepts, however, this level alone cannot support a conclusion concerning structural correspondence.

3.3.2 Concept

The conceptual level examines the meaning, scope, and theoretical role of the terms employed.

For example, the conceptual content of a third term differs depending on whether it mediates two terms, synthesizes them, or is itself a subjectivity. Conceptual analysis therefore moves beyond verbal resemblance to reconstruct the role that each concept performs within the theory under examination.

3.3.3 Structure

The structural level compares the arrangement, differentiation, dependence, and direction of constitution among concepts.

Even when two theories contain similar concepts, they do not share the same structure if the relations among those concepts differ. Structural comparison examines which terms are presupposed, which terms are constituted through relation, and which terms function as conditions for the constitution of others.

3.3.4 Ontology

The ontological level compares the kind of reality attributed to each component.

A third term treated as a psychological experience, epistemic construction, social description, linguistic form, or metaphor cannot be identified without qualification with a third term treated as an ontological subjectivity. Functional or descriptive similarity does not establish ontological equivalence when the relevant components are assigned different ontological statuses.

3.3.5 Operation

The operational level compares how components are generated, act upon one another, and alter the relation as a whole.

This level distinguishes the origin of generation, the constitution of intersection, the direction of constitution, the emergence of the third term, and the action of the third upon the originating terms. In comparisons with SIO, the question of what constitutes what is particularly important.

3.3.6 Empirical Consequence

The level of empirical consequence compares the observable outcomes that may be predicted by each theory.

Different ontologies may predict similar forms of synchronization, coordination, mutual transformation, or co-generation. Similar empirical consequences do not, however, establish that the theories adopt the same ontological structure. Conversely, structurally similar ontologies need not immediately yield identical empirical predictions.

The six levels are therefore distinguished as follows:

Lexical similarity $\neq$ conceptual equivalence
Conceptual similarity $\neq$ structural equivalence
Structural similarity $\neq$ ontological equivalence
Operational similarity $\neq$ empirical confirmation

This distinction makes it possible to state separately what corresponds and what does not correspond at each stage of the comparison.

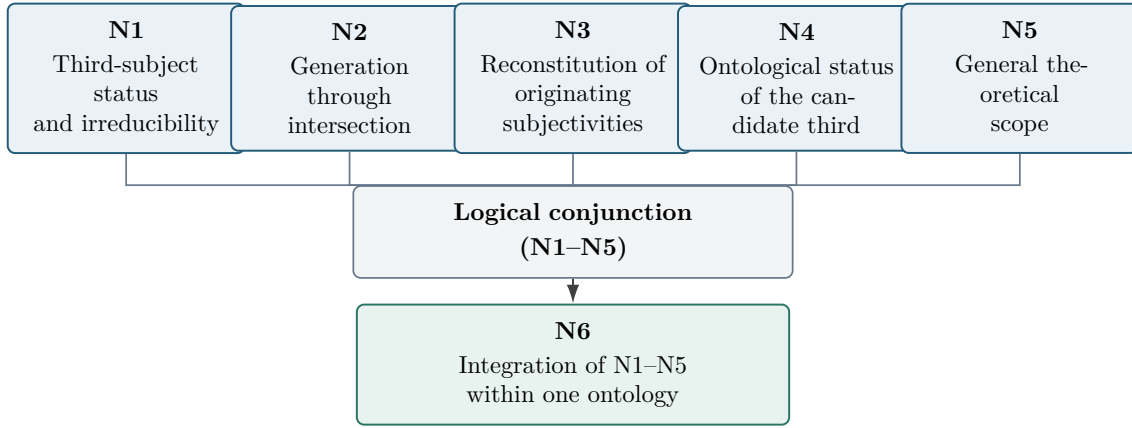
3.4 Structural Evaluation Criteria

This study organizes the structure of SIO defined in Chapter 2 into six explicit criteria, designated N1–N6. These criteria are not intended to score the philosophical value, historical importance, or truth of the theories under comparison. Their purpose is to examine, through a common framework, the extent to which a compared theory corresponds structurally with SIO.

Criterion	Evaluates
N1	Subjective status of the candidate third term
N2	Direction of generation through intersection
N3	Action upon and reconstitution of the originating subjectivities
N4	Ontological status of the candidate third term
N5	Generality and theoretical scope of the structure
N6	Integration of N1–N5 within a single ontology

Table 2. Structural evaluation criteria N1–N6.

N1–N6 are not additive scores. N1–N5 are structural criteria assessed separately, while N6 is not an additional scoring item but a conjunction condition for determining whether the required components are integrated within a single theory.



N6 is a conjunction condition—not an additional or additive score.

Figure 3. Logical relation among the comparative criteria. N1–N5 are independent, non-additive structural criteria. N6 is their conjunction condition.

3.4.1 N1—Irreducible Third Subjectivity

Does the compared theory posit a third term related to two subjectivities and treat that term as a subjectivity irreducible to their sum, average, metaphor, abstraction, functional device, or observer-dependent description?

The presence of a third term alone does not satisfy N1. The third must be assigned the status of subjectivity and must be irreducible to either originating subjectivity.

3.4.2 N2—Generation Through Intersection

Is the third subjectivity defined not as something existing independently prior to the relation, but as something generated through the constitutive intersection of differentiated subjectivities?

A structure in which two subjectivities are mediated by a pre-existing third term, or integrated into a pre-existing whole, does not by itself satisfy N2. The question is whether the third subjectivity is constituted through the intersection itself.

3.4.3 N3—Reconstitution of the Originating Subjectivities

Does the constituted third subjectivity act back upon the subjectivities from which it originates and transform, reorganize, or reconstitute their perspectives, relations, actions, or modes of existence?

N3 is not satisfied if the third subjectivity remains only a static result. The constitution of the third must alter the originating subjectivities in some relevant respect.

3.4.4 N4—Ontological Reality

Is the candidate third term treated as an ontological reality rather than being confined to an epistemological, psychological, sociological, linguistic, or metaphorical construct?

N4 does not assess whether the ontological claim made by the theory is true. It assesses the ontological status that the compared theory itself assigns to the candidate third term.

N4 is independent of N1 and N2. Satisfaction of N4 does not establish that the candidate third term is a subjectivity in the sense defined by SIO or that it is generated through

intersection. Whether the candidate third term has subjective status is assessed under N1, while whether its direction of generation proceeds through intersection is assessed under N2.

3.4.5 N5—General Theoretical Scope

Is the proposed structure formulated as a principle whose scope extends beyond a particular person, dyad, community, religion, culture, or exceptional case, and potentially to subjectivity and existence more generally?

A structure resembling SIO within a restricted domain may remain significant for comparison. If it is not formulated as a general ontological principle, however, that resemblance must be distinguished from satisfaction of N5.

3.4.6 N6—Complete Structural Conjunction

Does a single theory satisfy N1–N5 and integrate them within a self-consistent general ontology?

- differentiated subjectivities and an irreducible third subjectivity;
- generation of the third subjectivity through constitutive intersection;
- action of the third subjectivity upon and reconstitution of the originating subjectivities;
- ontological reality of the candidate third term; and
- generality and theoretical scope of the integrated structure.

N6 is not satisfied merely because some of these components are present. Nor can it be satisfied by collecting separate components from different periods, texts, schools, or mutually incompatible interpretations. N1–N5 must be integrated within what can defensibly be reconstructed as a single general ontology.

N6 is not an independent score added to N1–N5. It is a conjunction condition for determining whether the complete ontological structure of SIO is present as an integrated structure within the compared theory. N6 receives clear satisfaction only when N1–N5 are each clearly satisfied and integrated within a single ontology. If any of N1–N5 is not satisfied, N6 is not satisfied. Partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction is appropriate only where N1–N5 are each either clearly or partially satisfied, none is judged not satisfied, and the satisfaction or integration of at least one component remains interpretation-dependent. Insufficient evidence is recorded where one or more of N1–N5 cannot be determined from the available sources and no independently established non-satisfaction already decides the result.

3.5 Structural Equivalence

The principal unit of comparison adopted in this study is structure rather than vocabulary. Structural equivalence is not established merely because two theories employ the same terms or address similar themes.

An assessment of structural equivalence with SIO must compare at least the following elements:

- the terms constituting the theory;

- the differentiation among those terms;
- the ontological status of each term;
- the direction of constitution;
- the conditions under which the relation is constituted;
- the mode through which the third subjectivity is generated;
- the action of the third subjectivity upon the originating subjectivities; and
- the theoretical scope of the structure.

The direction of constitution is particularly important. Two theories may contain the same number of terms, yet differ structurally if the third term precedes the other two in one theory but is constituted through their intersection in the other. A structure in which the third term unilaterally constitutes the other two also differs from one in which two terms constitute a third that subsequently acts back upon them.

A triadic organization alone therefore does not establish structural equivalence with SIO. The status, dependencies, and direction of constitution of the respective terms must also correspond.

Structural equivalence does not mean that two theories are identical in every respect. It refers to correspondence with the central structure of SIO along the dimensions evaluated in this study. Differences in historical context, terminology, purpose, domain of application, or argumentative form are described separately from structural correspondence.

For the purposes of this study, a judgment of clear structural equivalence with SIO requires clear satisfaction of N1–N5 and clear satisfaction of N6 as their conjunction condition. Clear satisfaction of N6 is therefore a necessary condition for identifying clear structural equivalence. It does not, however, establish historical identity, intellectual influence, conceptual identity in every respect, or the truth of the ontology under comparison.

3.6 Boundaries of Structural Assessment

The presence of elements shared with SIO does not by itself establish that the compared theory is the same ontology. This study distinguishes similarity, partial correspondence, structural equivalence, and historical identity.

Shared vocabulary $\neq$ shared ontology
Triadic form $\neq$ structural equivalence
Functional similarity $\neq$ ontological identity
Historical priority $\neq$ complete anticipation of SIO
Structural equivalence $\neq$ historical influence

A theory's satisfaction of some of N1–N5 may indicate an important structural similarity. Partial satisfaction must nevertheless be distinguished from equivalence with the complete structure of SIO.

For example, a theory may recognize a third term without treating it as generated through intersection, in which case it does not satisfy N2. A theory may emphasize constitution

through relation without attributing subjectivity or ontological reality to the relation itself, in which case it does not satisfy N1 or N4. The originating subjectivities may also undergo change without that change being defined as the action of a third subjectivity, in which case satisfaction of N3 is limited.

This study restricts criterion-level judgments to four categories:

Assessment	Meaning
Clear satisfaction	The structure corresponding to the criterion is explicitly identifiable within the compared theory.
Partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction	Some structural correspondence is present, but its scope, ontological status, or interpretation remains uncertain.
Non-satisfaction	The corresponding structure is absent, or the compared theory explicitly proposes a different structure.
Insufficient evidence	The available sources or interpretations do not permit a determination.

Table 3. Criterion-level assessment categories.

These assessments are neither quantified nor added together, and they are not consolidated into a single grade. Insufficient evidence is not equivalent to non-satisfaction, and partial satisfaction is not merely a weaker expression of clear satisfaction. Each evaluation must specify what corresponds, what is absent, and what remains dependent upon interpretation.

3.7 Comparative Matrix

Each compared theory is evaluated against N1–N6 using the same format.

Criterion	SIO Requirement	Textual Evidence	Interpretive Reconstruction	Structural Assessment
N1	Definition in Chapter 2	—	—	—
N2	Definition in Chapter 2	—	—	—
N3	Definition in Chapter 2	—	—	—
N4	Definition in Chapter 2	—	—	—
N5	Definition in Chapter 2	—	—	—
N6	Conjunction of N1–N5	—	—	—

Table 4. Template separating textual evidence, interpretive reconstruction, and structural assessment.

The **SIO Requirement** column identifies the requirement corresponding to each criterion within the structure defined in Chapter 2.

The **Textual Evidence** column records passages from the primary sources of the compared theory and, where necessary, the bibliographic information required to locate them. As far as possible, this column reports what the compared theory states without anticipating the subsequent structural judgment.

The **Interpretive Reconstruction** column explains how the textual evidence is understood as a structure within the theory’s own terminology, historical context, and internal relations. Where interpretation is contested, the principal alternatives and the grounds for the reconstruction adopted in this study are stated.

The **Structural Assessment** column compares the reconstructed structure with N1–N6 and records clear satisfaction, partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction, non-

satisfaction, or insufficient evidence. Relevant qualifications are reported together with the assessment.

This three-stage separation distinguishes objections concerning textual evidence from objections concerning the reconstruction of a theory and from objections concerning the application of the structural criteria. A reader may dispute one stage without necessarily rejecting the other stages or the comparative method as a whole.

Cross-case judgments concerning structural correspondence and the historical position of SIO are reserved for the comparative synthesis in Chapter 5, where they are derived from the criterion-level evidence rather than assigned within individual comparisons.

3.8 Methodological Scope

The framework developed in this chapter is presented as one possible method for comparative ontology. It is neither the only legitimate form of comparison nor a replacement for intellectual history, genealogy, philology, conceptual history, comparative phenomenology, or contextualist inquiry. Different research questions require different comparative criteria.

N1–N6 are not neutral and universal measures for evaluating ontology in general. They are intentionally SIO-relative criteria constructed to examine structural correspondence with the ontology defined in Chapter 2.

This theory-relative character does not constitute a defect in the method. Fairness in the present study does not depend upon criteria that are independent of every theory. It depends upon making the object, conditions, and limits of comparison explicit and applying the same criteria consistently to every comparison case.

N1–N6 are defined prior to their application to individual cases in this manuscript. This ordering does not imply that they were preregistered before the historical research or remained fixed from the beginning of the research process. This study makes no claim that the criteria were preregistered, fixed prior to review, or predetermined before the historical comparison.

The methodology does not evaluate:

- the truth of religious doctrine;
- the philosophical superiority of the compared theory;
- its importance in intellectual history;
- its moral, political, or cultural value;
- direct historical influence upon SIO;
- the truth of SIO itself; or
- the empirical validity of SIO.

Structural similarity does not establish historical influence. Conversely, a determination that a historically prior theory differs structurally from SIO does not diminish that theory's philosophical significance.

The results of the comparison remain limited to the sources and interpretations examined. Failure to identify structural equivalence in a particular case does not demonstrate the absence

of an equivalent ontology from the philosophical record as a whole. Additional primary sources, unexamined traditions, alternative translations, or new interpretations may require revision of an individual assessment or of the overall conclusion.

3.9 Comparative Procedure and Summary

Each comparison begins by identifying representative primary sources and relevant scholarship. The compared ontology is then reconstructed in its own terminology and historical context. The analysis distinguishes the lexical, conceptual, structural, ontological, operational, and empirical levels before evaluating N1–N5 individually and N6 as a conjunction condition. For each criterion, the textual evidence, interpretive reconstruction, structural assessment, and relevant qualifications are reported separately.

The purpose of this procedure is not to eliminate interpretive disagreement. It is to make it possible to identify whether a disagreement concerns the selection of sources, the understanding of textual evidence, the reconstruction of the theory, the application of a criterion, or the resulting structural assessment. A reader may dispute an individual item of evidence, interpretation, or assessment without rejecting the comparative method as a whole.

Chapter 2 defined SIO, while the present chapter has defined the rules by which its structure will be compared with other ontologies. The following chapters apply these rules without redefining SIO or modifying the criteria in response to individual cases. Accordingly, every comparison will distinguish explicitly between textual evidence, interpretive reconstruction, and structural assessment.

4 Historical Comparison of Ontologies

4.1 Purpose and Scope of This Chapter

This chapter applies the comparative method established in Chapter 3 to major historical and contemporary ontologies. Its purpose is not to rank the philosophical value of these theories, but to examine their structural correspondence with Subjectivity Intersection Ontology (SIO) individually under N1–N6.

The cases were included for two reasons. First, they present representative structures concerning unity, plurality, substance, process, emanation, nonduality, or dependent constitution that have exerted a continuing influence on subsequent ontology. Second, their accounts of triadicity, constitutive relation, the ontological status of subjectivity, or the emergence of relational organization permit direct comparison with at least one of N1–N6. Not every case must satisfy both considerations to the same degree, but each has a clearly identifiable comparative role under at least one of them.

On this basis, the chapter examines six lineages: ancient Greek philosophy; Indian philosophy; Christian Trinitarian ontology; German Idealism; process ontology and phenomenology; and contemporary relational theories.

The selection is not exhaustive of the world's ontological traditions. Traditions not examined here, including Chinese philosophy, Islamic philosophy, Jewish philosophy, and mystical thought, may contain further candidates requiring comparison. A failure to identify structural equivalence in this chapter would therefore not establish that no equivalent structure exists anywhere in the history of philosophy.

Each comparison distinguishes textual evidence, interpretive reconstruction, and structural assessment. The textual-evidence subsection identifies representative primary sources and their principal concepts. The interpretive-reconstruction subsection describes how those concepts relate within the theory itself. The structural-assessment subsection then evaluates that reconstruction under N1–N6.

The assessments used in this chapter are limited to four categories:

- clear satisfaction;
- partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction;
- non-satisfaction; and
- insufficient evidence.

An assessment under N4 concerns the ontological status assigned to the candidate third term within the compared theory. It does not imply that this term is identical to Intersection Subjectivity in SIO. Whether the third term is a subjectivity is assessed independently under N1, and whether it is generated through intersection is assessed independently under N2.

N6 is not an additional scoring item appended to N1–N5. It is a conjunction condition assessing whether those criteria are integrated within a single general ontology. N6 receives clear satisfaction only when N1–N5 are all clearly satisfied and integrated within one ontology. If any of N1–N5 is not satisfied, N6 is also not satisfied. If none is judged not satisfied, but at least one criterion or their integration remains interpretation-dependent, N6 receives partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction.

These assessments are neither added together nor converted into an overall grade. Nor does this chapter classify individual theories by summary labels such as “precedent” or “closest comparison.” Cross-case evaluation is reserved for Chapter 5.

4.2 Ancient Greek Philosophy

Ancient Greek philosophy established major ontological alternatives concerning unity and plurality, being and becoming, form and appearance, substance and relation, and origin and derivation. This section examines Parmenides, Heraclitus, Plato, Aristotle, and Plotinus.

4.2.1 Parmenides

Textual Evidence. The “Way of Truth” in Parmenides’ poem presents what-is as ungenerated, imperishable, complete, indivisible, and unchanging. What-is cannot arise from what-is-not or pass into what-is-not. Becoming, destruction, motion, and plurality do not belong to being in the strict sense, but are assigned to the domain of mortal opinion (DK 28 B8.1–49; Laks and Most 2016; Curd 1998).

Interpretive Reconstruction. Within this structure, the unity and self-identity of being have ontological priority. Difference and becoming are not admitted as constitutive of being itself. The structural conditions required for a new subjectivity to arise from a relation between differentiated subjectivities are therefore absent.

Like SIO, Parmenides addresses primordial unity. That unity, however, is not presented as internally containing perspectival difference or intersection. A shared concern with unity at the level of problem formulation does not entail structural correspondence.

Structural Assessment. N1, N2, and N3 are not satisfied. No third subjectivity, generation of such a subjectivity through intersection, or action upon originating subjectivities is proposed. N4 is also not satisfied: although being in general is assigned a strong reality, there is no candidate third term. N5 and N6 are not satisfied because the structure corresponding to SIO is not proposed.

Limitation of the present comparison: Parmenides' work survives only in fragments, and the retrospective application of modern concepts of subjectivity to his ontology is necessarily limited.

4.2.2 Heraclitus

Textual Evidence. The fragments of Heraclitus depict the cosmos as ordered through change, tension, opposition, and transformation. Opposites are not merely exclusive, but are mutually related within a single order. *Logos* appears as the principle indicating that such change follows a common order rather than constituting arbitrary flux (DK 22 B1, B10, B50, B51; Laks and Most 2016; Graham 2010).

Interpretive Reconstruction. In Heraclitus, stability may be understood not as the negation of change but as an order maintained through change. Opposed terms form a structure through their tension or interdependence. In this respect, the account holds difference and unity together.

The opposed terms, however, are not defined as differentiated subjectivities, nor does their relation generate an irreducible third subjectivity. The *logos* is likewise not a third subjectivity constituted through the intersection of two subjectivities.

Structural Assessment. Process, opposition, and relation provide points of conceptual comparison, but the structures specified by N1–N3 are not identifiable. N4 is not satisfied because no candidate third term is assigned subjective and ontological status. Although Heraclitus' cosmology has general scope, it does not present the SIO-type structure addressed by N5 as a general principle; N5 is therefore not satisfied. N6 is also not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: The assessment depends on a fragmentary textual tradition and on the ordering and interpretation of those fragments. It does not resolve the interpretive disputes concerning the *logos* and the unity of opposites.

4.2.3 Plato

Textual Evidence. Plato's dialogues discuss in different ways the distinction between sensible particulars and intelligible Forms, the participation of particulars in Forms, and the relations among Forms. The *Phaedo* and the *Republic* emphasize the stability of intelligible Forms, while the *Parmenides* and the *Sophist* examine participation, difference, being, and the relations among kinds in more complex terms (*Phaedo* 74a–76e; *Republic* 509d–511e; *Parmenides* 130a–135d; *Sophist* 251a–259e; Plato 1997; Fine 1999).

Interpretive Reconstruction. In Platonic ontology, the determinacy of particulars is explained through their relation to Forms. In the later dialogues, it becomes difficult to under-

stand being simply as an inventory of isolated Forms, and difference and relation enter into ontological analysis.

Forms, particulars, and participation, however, do not constitute a structure of two differentiated subjectivities and a third subjectivity arising from their intersection. Dialectical mediation and relations among Forms do not themselves become new subjectivities.

Structural Assessment. N1–N3 are not satisfied. N4 is not satisfied because there is no candidate third term. Although the theory of Forms is presented as a general ontology, it does not present an SIO-type generative structure as a general principle; N5 is therefore not satisfied. N6 is also not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: Plato’s ontology develops through dialogues with differing problems and argumentative trajectories. Any reconstruction of the theory of Forms, participation, and relations among kinds as a single fixed system is therefore limited.

4.2.4 Aristotle

Textual Evidence. In the *Categories*, primary substances are treated as individual beings that are neither predicated of a subject nor present in a subject. Relation is recognized as one category, but ordinarily depends upon the relata. In the *Metaphysics*, substance is analyzed through form, matter, and their composite, with form playing a central role in explaining what a thing is (*Categories* 2a11–19, 6a36–8b24; *Metaphysics* VII.1–3, 1028a10–1029a30; Aristotle 1984; Loux 1991).

Interpretive Reconstruction. Aristotle does not deny the reality or explanatory importance of relations. Ontological priority is nevertheless assigned principally to substance. Relations may connect, qualify, and explain substances, but relation itself is not treated as an ontological source that generates a new subjectivity.

This structure contrasts with the SIO proposal that relation may not merely connect existing terms but may constitute a third subjectivity. The contrast does not imply that Aristotle regarded relations as unreal.

Structural Assessment. N1–N4 are not satisfied. Aristotle’s theories of substance and relation have general scope, but they do not present the generation of a third subjectivity through intersection as a general principle; N5 is therefore not satisfied. N6 is consequently not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: This assessment is based principally on the accounts of substance and relation in the *Categories* and the *Metaphysics*. It does not reduce Aristotle’s philosophy as a whole—including his accounts of soul, community, and generation—to a simple “substantialism.”

4.2.5 Plotinus

Textual Evidence. The *Enneads* present a hierarchical structure of the One, Intellect (*Nous*), and Soul. The One exceeds being and plurality. Intellect proceeds from the One and contains the intelligible Forms as a unified multiplicity, while Soul proceeds from Intellect and mediates between intelligible order and the sensible cosmos. Procession is accompanied by return toward the source (*Enneads* V.1.6–7, V.2.1–2; Plotinus 2017; Gerson 1994; Emilsson 2007).

Interpretive Reconstruction. Plotinus’ structure is triadic, and Intellect and Soul are assigned derivative yet real status. Procession and return describe more than a static hierarchy: what proceeds remains directed toward its source.

Intellect, however, is not generated through the intersection of two differentiated subjectivities, and Soul is not a third subjectivity constituted through the intersection of two prior subjectivities. The direction of constitution is asymmetrical, proceeding from source to derivative terms; the derived Soul does not reconstitute the One and Intellect.

Structural Assessment. The triadic structure and the subjective character attributable to Intellect and Soul provide partial and interpretation-dependent correspondence under N1. N2 and N3 are not satisfied.

The ontological reality of Intellect and Soul is itself clear. It is nevertheless interpretation-dependent which term in the hierarchy of the One, Intellect, and Soul should be selected as the candidate third term for comparison with SIO. N4 therefore receives partial or interpretation-dependent rather than clear satisfaction. Because the triadic cosmology is presented as a general ontology, N5 is clearly satisfied. Since N2 and N3 are not satisfied, N6 is not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: Applying the modern comparative terms “subjectivity” and “third term” to the One, Intellect, and Soul is itself an interpretive reconstruction whose correspondence is not guaranteed by identical terminology in the primary texts.

4.2.6 Criterion-Level Summary: Ancient Greek Philosophy

Thinker	N1	N2	N3	N4	N5	N6
Parmenides	N	N	N	N	N	N
Heraclitus	N	N	N	N	N	N
Plato	N	N	N	N	N	N
Aristotle	N	N	N	N	N	N
Plotinus	P	N	N	P	C	N

Table 5. Criterion-level assessments: ancient Greek philosophy.

C = clear satisfaction; P = partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction; N = non-satisfaction; I = insufficient evidence.

This table summarizes the criterion-level assessments; it does not constitute an overall evaluation. Each cell must be read in light of the preceding textual evidence and interpretive reconstruction.

4.3 Indian Philosophy

Indian philosophy developed diverse and mutually opposed ontologies of consciousness, self, substance, causation, dependence, plurality, change, and nonduality. This section examines separately the Upaniṣads and Advaita Vedānta, Sāṃkhya and Classical Yoga, Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika, early Buddhism, Madhyamaka, Jain philosophy, and Kashmir Śaivism.

These traditions have distinct historical contexts, primary texts, problems, and conceptual systems. “Indian philosophy” cannot therefore be treated as a single unified ontology. Each case is subject to the same evidential burden: representative texts must be identified, the theory must be reconstructed internally, and N1–N6 must be assessed individually.

4.3.1 The Upaniṣads and Advaita Vedānta

Textual Evidence. The early Upaniṣads discuss the relation between self (*ātman*) and ultimate reality (*brahman*) in diverse forms (*Bṛhadāraṇyaka Upaniṣad* 1.4.10, 3.7.1–23; *Chāndogya Upaniṣad* 6.8.7–6.16.3; Olivelle 1998; Cohen 2024). In the later system of Advaita Vedānta, particularly as associated with Śaṅkara, the true self is understood not as body, psyche, or personal history, but as pure consciousness non-different from *brahman* (Śaṅkara 1992; Deutsch 1969).

The Upaniṣads are not a single systematic work and contain multiple formulations concerning self, cosmos, unity, and difference. The present reconstruction does not reduce all of them to one doctrine, but concentrates on the nondual interpretation systematized in Advaita.

Interpretive Reconstruction. Empirical plurality operates at the level of conventional experience, but at the level of ultimate reality consciousness is not divided into numerically independent selves. Liberation occurs not through the generation of a new subjectivity from the intersection of multiple subjectivities, but through recognition of the non-difference of *ātman* and *brahman*.

Structural Assessment. N1–N3 are not satisfied because there is no intersection of differentiated subjectivities and no generation of a third subjectivity. Although consciousness is assigned ultimate reality, N4 is not satisfied because no candidate third term is proposed. Since no SIO-type structure is formulated as a general principle, N5 and N6 are also not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: Combining the plurality of positions in the Upaniṣads with the systematic Advaita of the later Śaṅkara tradition in a single entry has clear limits. The assessment does not presuppose their complete identity.

4.3.2 Sāṃkhya and Classical Yoga

Textual Evidence. Sāṃkhya, as represented by the *Sāṃkhyakārikā*, proposes a dualism of *puruṣa*, pure consciousness, and *prakṛti*, changing primordial nature. From *prakṛti* develop intellect, ego, mind, sensory capacities, subtle elements, and the material world (*Sāṃkhyakārikā* 3, 17, 21–22; Īśvarakṛṣṇa 1969; Larson and Bhattacharya 1987). Classical Yoga adopts much of this ontology and connects liberation to discrimination between *puruṣa* and *prakṛti* (*Yoga Sūtras* 1.24, 2.18–26; Patañjali 2009).

Classical Sāṃkhya generally recognizes a plurality of *puruṣas*, each of which is immutable and witnesses the changes of *prakṛti*. The recognition in Classical Yoga of Īśvara as a special *puruṣa* does not dissolve the fundamental distinction between consciousness and nature.

Interpretive Reconstruction. Cosmological evolution begins through the proximity of *puruṣa* and *prakṛti*, but *puruṣa* neither changes nor acts. The generated principles are transformations of *prakṛti*. Their conjunction makes experience possible, but does not constitute a third subjectivity from their intersection.

Structural Assessment. The difference and conjunction of two principles are recognized, but no third subjectivity is generated. N1–N4 are therefore not satisfied. Although Sāṃkhya presents a general cosmology, it does not generalize an SIO-type structure of intersection; N5 and N6 are not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: Sāṃkhya and Classical Yoga differ concerning Īśvara, practice, and liberation. The assessment is restricted to the *puruṣa-prakṛti* structure they share.

4.3.3 Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika

Textual Evidence. Nyāya and Vaiśeṣika developed systems of categories including substance, quality, motion, universal, particularity, inherence, and, in later formulations, absence. The self is treated as an enduring substance, while material reality includes atoms and composites. Relations such as conjunction, disjunction, and inherence explain composites, qualities, and part–whole structures (*Nyāya Sūtra* 1.1.9–10; Gautama 2017; *Vaiśeṣikasūtra* 1.1.4–16; Kaṇāda 2021; Potter 1977; Ganeri 2001).

The two schools did not originate as a single system, but became integrated through historical development. Their number of categories, accounts of self, and relation to epistemology vary across periods. The present comparison considers their mature realist categorial framework.

Interpretive Reconstruction. Within this framework, relations play an important role in organizing reality and explaining the constitution of composites. Subjectivity, however, belongs primarily to enduring selves and is not newly generated through relation. Even where a composite whole is not reducible to a mere aggregate of parts, the emergence of a new subjectivity does not follow.

Structural Assessment. The reality of relations and wholes is recognized, but the generation of a third subjectivity and reconstitution of originating subjectivities are not proposed. N1–N4 are therefore not satisfied. Nor is an SIO-type structure generalized; N5 and N6 are not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: This assessment reconstructs the schools’ long historical development in terms of a mature categorial realism and does not evaluate every ontological and epistemological difference between periods.

4.3.4 Early Buddhism

Textual Evidence. Early Buddhist texts analyze the person in terms of changing components such as the five aggregates and maintain that no permanent, autonomous self can be found. Dependent origination explains phenomena as arising in dependence upon conditions, accounting for experience, action, suffering, and continuity without positing an enduring self-substance (*Samyutta Nikāya* 12.1, 22.59; Bodhi 2000; Gethin 1998).

These doctrines were developed into different ontological and epistemological systems by later Buddhist schools. This section therefore treats early Buddhism not as a completed and unified relational ontology, but as a historical structure defined by non-self and conditioned arising.

Interpretive Reconstruction. This structure permits comparison with constitutive relation insofar as it prioritizes conditioned arising over independent substance. Its analytical direction, however, is not to generate a third subjectivity from the intersection of multiple subjectivities, but to dismantle attachment to an enduring subjective substance.

Dependent origination has partial conceptual correspondence with generation through intersection, but what arises is not defined as a third subjectivity constituted between two subjectivities.

Structural Assessment. N1 and N3 are not satisfied. N2 receives partial correspondence because of the structure of conditioned arising, but the generation does not occur through an intersection between differentiated subjectivities. N4 is not satisfied because no candidate third term is assigned ontological reality. Although dependent origination has broad scope, it does not generalize an SIO-type structure; N5 therefore receives only partial satisfaction. Since N1, N3, and N4 are not satisfied, N6 is not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: “Early Buddhism” encompasses multiple textual strata and doctrines. “Relational ontology” is also a modern interpretive term rather than the tradition’s own description.

4.3.5 Madhyamaka

Textual Evidence. Madhyamaka, originating with Nāgārjuna’s *Mūlamadhyamakakārikā*, argues that all phenomena lack intrinsic nature (*svabhāva*). Emptiness does not signify simple nonexistence; it indicates that phenomena lack independent self-grounding and function in dependence upon causal, conceptual, and practical conditions. Emptiness itself is not presented as a new substance (*Mūlamadhyamakakārikā* 15.1–2, 24.18–19; Nāgārjuna 2013; Siderits 2007; Westerhoff 2009).

The distinction between conventional and ultimate truth prevents the critique of intrinsic reality from becoming a wholesale denial of ordinary or practical causation. Because Madhyamaka itself contains interpretive differences, this section does not reduce all of its forms to a single doctrine.

Interpretive Reconstruction. Madhyamaka offers a powerful critique of treating independent substances as the ultimate units of ontology. Phenomena are constituted through relation and dependence, but those dependencies are not said to generate a new subjective substance. Indeed, assigning intrinsic reality to a third term arising from intersection could be criticized as a reintroduction of *svabhāva*.

Structural Assessment. N1 and N3 are not satisfied. The general structure of dependent constitution provides partial correspondence under N2. N4 is not satisfied because no candidate third term is assigned independent ontological status. Although the analysis of dependence has general scope, it does not generalize the SIO structure of a third subjectivity; N5 receives partial satisfaction. Since N1, N3, and N4 are not satisfied, N6 is not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: Madhyamaka contains major interpretive differences concerning the two truths, emptiness, language, and the status of ontological claims. This assessment does not fix those differences into a single metaphysical position.

4.3.6 Jain Philosophy

Textual Evidence. Jain philosophy presents a pluralist realism recognizing many individual living selves (*jīva*) and non-living realities (*ajīva*). Substances persist while undergoing modal change. The doctrine of many-sidedness (*anekāntavāda*) holds that reality cannot be

exhausted by a single unqualified proposition and requires qualified descriptions from different standpoints (*Tattvārtha Sūtra* 2.8–13, 5.29; Umāsvāti 1994; Dundas 2002).

Conditional predication does not reduce truth to arbitrary subjectivity. It specifies the standpoint and qualification under which a proposition is valid, thereby addressing both the many-sided character of reality and the partial character of cognition.

Interpretive Reconstruction. In Jain philosophy, perspectival plurality enables different aspects of the same reality to be described appropriately. Multiple standpoints are not reduced to arbitrary subjectivism, but neither does their intersection generate a new third subjectivity.

Structural Assessment. Multiple subjects and perspectives are recognized, but no irreducible third subjectivity is proposed; N1 is not satisfied. Although there is a limited resemblance in the conditioning of standpoints, this does not constitute the generation of subjectivity through intersection, so N2 is not satisfied. N3 and N4 are also not satisfied. Perspectival plurality is presented as a general principle, but not as an SIO-type structure; N5 receives partial satisfaction. N6 is not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: *Anekāntavāda* spans ontology, logic, epistemology, and theories of predication. Reading it as a theory of intersection between subjectivities is therefore conceptually limited.

4.3.7 Kashmir Śaivism

Textual Evidence. The Pratyabhijñā tradition associated with Utpaladeva and Abhinavagupta understands ultimate reality as a single self-manifesting consciousness endowed with the powers of knowledge and action. Utpaladeva’s opening verses identify recognition of the Lord as recognition of one’s own consciousness and connect subjectivity with the powers of cognition and agency (Utpaladeva 1994, ĪPK I.1.1–5). His analysis of manifestation argues that an object cannot be manifested as something wholly external to the consciousness in which it appears (Utpaladeva 1994, ĪPK I.5.1–2).

The later sections of the work distinguish transindividual consciousness from the layers with which a limited subject identifies, including void, life-force, the internal faculties, and the body (Utpaladeva 1994, ĪPK III.1.8, III.2.12–13). Abhinavagupta’s *Īśvarapratyabhijñāvimarśinī*, in its commentary on these passages, develops the relation between universal consciousness, contracted subjectivity, recognition, and the transformation of the limited subject (Abhinavagupta 1986, ad ĪPK I.1.1–5, I.5.1–2, III.1.8, and III.2.12–13; Wallis 2020, 144–169).

On this account, the world is not an unreal appearance external to consciousness. Differentiation is a manifestation of the freedom and power of consciousness, while finite subjects arise through determinate forms of limitation or contraction. Recognition transforms finite self-understanding by disclosing its relation to the universal subject.

“Kashmir Śaivism” does not designate a single homogeneous school. The present comparison primarily addresses the systematic ontology of consciousness developed in the Pratyabhijñā tradition while preserving its differences from other Śaiva traditions.

Interpretive Reconstruction. This ontology integrates unitary consciousness, differentiated manifestation, triadic structures, and transformation of finite subjectivity. The finite subject changes not through the external addition of a new entity, but through recognition of its already-established identity with universal consciousness.

Its direction of constitution therefore differs from SIO, in which a third subjectivity is generated through the intersection of differentiated subjectivities. Triadicity arises within Śiva’s self-manifestation; a third subjectivity is not explicitly said to arise anew between two subjectivities.

Structural Assessment. The triadic structure of consciousness provides partial and interpretation-dependent correspondence under N1. Because differentiation and manifestation are understood dynamically, N2 also receives partial correspondence, although this is not identical to generation through intersection. Recognition transforms finite subjectivity, providing partial correspondence under N3.

It is clear that consciousness and its manifestations are assigned ontological reality. It is not unambiguous, however, which among the several triadic structures—knower, knowing, and known; Śiva, Śakti, and manifestation; or others—should be selected as the candidate corresponding to SIO’s third subjectivity. N4 therefore receives partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction at this stage.

The structure is presented as a general ontology, so N5 is clearly satisfied. Although none of N1–N4 is judged not satisfied, their satisfaction and integration remain interpretation-dependent; N6 therefore receives partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction.

Limitation of the present comparison: This assessment is based principally on the systematic account of the Pratyabhijñā school. The extraction of a candidate corresponding to SIO from the several triadic structures within Kashmir Śaivism is itself an interpretive choice.

4.3.8 Criterion-Level Summary: Indian Philosophy

Tradition	N1	N2	N3	N4	N5	N6
Upaniṣads / Advaita	N	N	N	N	N	N
Sāṃkhya / Classical Yoga	N	N	N	N	N	N
Nyāya / Vaiśeṣika	N	N	N	N	N	N
Early Buddhism	N	P	N	N	P	N
Madhyamaka	N	P	N	N	P	N
Jain Philosophy	N	N	N	N	P	N
Kashmir Śaivism	P	P	P	P	C	P

Table 6. Criterion-level assessments: Indian philosophical traditions.

C = clear satisfaction; P = partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction; N = non-satisfaction; I = insufficient evidence.

4.4 Trinitarian Ontology and Christian Metaphysics

4.4.1 Textual Evidence

The creed issued at Nicaea in 325 expressed, through the term *homoousios*, that the Son is of the same essence or substance as the Father. The creed conventionally associated with Constantinople in 381 provided a more explicit confession of the status of the Holy Spirit, although the documentary history of that creed and its relation to the council requires historical qualification (Tanner 1990, 1:5–6, 21–24; Ayres 2004).

The Cappadocian distinction between one divine essence (*ousia*) and three hypostases (*hypostaseis*) was neither established instantaneously nor employed with complete terminological uniformity. Basil’s *On the Holy Spirit* distinguishes the hypostases while emphasizing the

coordination and inseparability of divine activity (Basil of Caesarea 2011, chs. 16–18; Ayres 2004).

Gregory of Nyssa addresses the unity and differentiation of the divine in both *Against Eunomius* and the shorter treatise *To Ablabius: On Not Three Gods* (Gregory of Nyssa 1893a, 1893b). In the latter, Gregory explicitly considers why Father, Son, and Holy Spirit should not be enumerated as three Gods in the manner in which three human individuals are enumerated. His response emphasizes the non-separation of divine activity: the activity attributed to the Father is realized through the Son and completed in the Holy Spirit, and is therefore not divided into three independent operations (Gregory of Nyssa 1893b, 331–336; Ayres 2002, 445–474; Radde-Gallwitz 2018, 129–164).

Augustine’s *De Trinitate* analyzed the distinction among the three through relation while maintaining their equality and unity (Augustine 1991, books V–VII). Later Eastern and Western traditions addressed the eternal relations of origin among Father, Son, and Holy Spirit, mutual indwelling (*perichoresis*), and hypostases distinguished by relation.

“Trinitarian ontology” was not expressed through a single, identical vocabulary and theory in every period and confession. Eastern and Western traditions developed different emphases and formulations concerning hypostasis, essence, relation, and the procession of the Holy Spirit. The present section acknowledges these differences while examining the basic structure shared within the Nicene tradition.

4.4.2 Interpretive Reconstruction

The basic Trinitarian structure maintains simultaneously one divine essence and three distinct hypostases: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. The three are neither parts composing a whole nor three independent substances belonging to the same kind. Relation is not an external addition to already completed individuals, but an internal element in understanding hypostatic distinction.

Hypostasis, however, cannot be identified without qualification with modern individual consciousness or with subjectivity in SIO. The Holy Spirit is understood as an eternal divine hypostasis, not as a third subjectivity newly generated by the intersection of two subjectivities. Eastern and Western traditions formulate the procession of the Spirit differently, but neither formulation is immediately equivalent to intersectional emergence in SIO.

In classical Trinitarian ontology, Father, Son, and Holy Spirit are eternally their respective hypostases. It does not therefore adopt a developmental structure in which the constitution of the third hypostasis subsequently reconstitutes the modes of existence of Father and Son.

4.4.3 Structural Assessment

Because three irreducible hypostases are recognized within indivisible unity, N1 receives partial and interpretation-dependent correspondence. N2 is not satisfied because the Holy Spirit is not defined as a subjectivity emerging from intersection. N3 is also not satisfied because the divine hypostases are immutable.

Within the doctrine, the Holy Spirit is explicitly the third hypostasis and possesses full divine reality. N4 is therefore clearly satisfied. This assessment concerns the ontological reality of the Holy Spirit as the third hypostasis; it does not imply conceptual identity between the Holy Spirit and Intersection Subjectivity in SIO.

The structure is principally a theological ontology of divine being and is not univocally presented as a principle of subjectivity and existence in general. N5 therefore receives partial satisfaction. Since N2 and N3 are not satisfied, N6 is not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: This assessment is restricted to representative structures within the Nicene tradition. It does not treat Eastern and Western accounts of procession, hypostasis, relation, or modern social Trinitarian theories as a single homogeneous system.

Tradition	N1	N2	N3	N4	N5	N6
Christian Trinitarian Ontology	P	N	N	C	P	N

Table 7. Criterion-level assessment: Christian Trinitarian ontology.

C = clear satisfaction; P = partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction; N = non-satisfaction; I = insufficient evidence.

4.5 German Idealism

This section treats Schelling and Hegel as distinct philosophical developments. Both sought to understand nature, spirit, freedom, and being as dynamic structures, but their methods, systems, and later philosophies are not identical. In keeping with the purpose of this chapter, the comparison is limited to these two figures and does not attempt a comprehensive intellectual history of German Idealism.

4.5.1 Schelling

Textual Evidence. Schelling’s philosophy of nature does not treat nature as an aggregate of finished products. In *Ideas for a Philosophy of Nature*, nature is approached genetically, as a productive activity manifested in particular products and continuous processes of becoming (Schelling 1988, 42, 133–134). The *System of Transcendental Idealism* correspondingly presents philosophy as a progressive history of self-consciousness. Its successive epochs reconstruct the emergence of intuition, reflection, will, organization, and objectivity from the activities of intelligence (Schelling 1978, 50, 90, 125–126, 134). Near the conclusion of the account of history, Schelling describes the objective world as arising through an initially non-conscious mechanism of intelligence (Schelling 1978, 213).

The *Freedom Essay* introduces a distinction between being insofar as it exists and being insofar as it constitutes the ground of existence. Ground and existence are differentiated without being treated as two independently existing substances (Schelling 2006, 27–32 [SW VII:357–364]). The 1815 version of *The Ages of the World* places this distinction within a temporal account of the development of a living and actual being (Schelling 2000, xxxv–xl, 3–74). In the later Berlin lectures, Schelling distinguishes negative philosophy, which investigates what beings can be through reason, from positive philosophy, which begins from the actuality of existence that cannot be derived from conceptual possibility alone (Schelling 2007, 141–212).

These texts belong to different phases of Schelling’s philosophy and should not be combined as though they constituted one unchanged system (Beiser 2002; Bowie 1993).

Interpretive Reconstruction. Schelling understands nature not as an inventory of completed substances, but as a dynamic productivity that generates new forms. Subject and

object are likewise treated not as two unrelated substances, but as different expressions of a more primordial unity.

At least in the early philosophy and the philosophy of identity, however, this development is explained through the self-manifestation of the Absolute or the productivity of nature. No general principle explicitly states that the constitutive intersection of two differentiated subjectivities generates an irreducible third subjectivity. The later philosophy's criticism of deriving actuality necessarily from concepts does not itself entail the structure of intersection proposed by SIO.

Structural Assessment. Dynamic development, differentiation, and the generation of new forms provide partial structural correspondence under N1 and N2, although no third subjectivity is explicit. N3 also remains an interpretation-dependent partial satisfaction with respect to the action of generated forms upon preceding structures. N4 receives partial satisfaction because the ontological status of the candidate third term is not clear. Since Schelling's structure is presented as a general ontology, N5 is clearly satisfied.

None of N1–N4 is judged not satisfied, but their satisfaction and mutual integration remain interpretation-dependent. Under the N6 rule established in Chapter 3, N6 therefore receives partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction.

Limitation of the present comparison: Schelling's philosophy of nature, philosophy of identity, philosophy of freedom, *Ages of the World*, and positive philosophy do not form a single completed system. Their integration across periods is itself an interpretive reconstruction.

4.5.2 Hegel

Textual Evidence. The *Phenomenology of Spirit* presents consciousness not as a fixed possession but as a succession of forms whose claims are tested and transformed through experience. In the account of recognition, self-consciousness is articulated through its relation to another self-consciousness rather than as an independently completed interior substance (Hegel 2018, §§178–196).

The *Science of Logic* similarly treats categorial development as internal to the determinations themselves rather than as an externally imposed sequence. At the beginning of the work, pure being and pure nothing pass into becoming through their mutual instability (Hegel 2010b, 59–60). At its conclusion, the absolute idea is presented through a method whose movement belongs to the content rather than being externally applied to it (Hegel 2010b, 735–753). The *Encyclopaedia* organizes the philosophical system into Logic, Nature, and Spirit, describing Spirit as the Idea returning from its otherness in Nature (Hegel 2010a, §18).

In Part III of the *Encyclopaedia*, objective spirit encompasses right, morality, and ethical life. Individual freedom thereby acquires determinate form through social practices, legal institutions, and shared forms of ethical life rather than remaining an exclusively private capacity (Hegel 2007, §§483–552; Pippin 2008).

Interpretive Reconstruction. For Hegel, identity does not arise independently of difference, negation, and mediation. Self-consciousness is likewise not an isolated inner substance, but becomes concrete through recognition by others, language, norms, and social institutions.

Norms and institutions arising from mutual recognition are not reducible to individual intentions and may act back upon individuals. In this respect, the structure partially cor-

responds to the operational form in SIO whereby a structure constituted through relation transforms the originating subjectivities.

Objective spirit and institutions, however, are not explicitly defined as irreducible third subjectivities emerging from the intersection of two subjectivities. Nor can every dialectical third term be treated as a subjectivity. At the systematic level, development is understood as the self-development of the Concept or Spirit, and its direction of constitution is therefore not identical to that of SIO. Treating objective spirit as a candidate third term consequently remains an interpretive reconstruction rather than an explicit Hegelian formulation (Moyar 2017).

Structural Assessment. Recognition, mediation, and objective spirit provide partial and interpretation-dependent correspondence under N1–N3. Because the subjective and ontological status of the candidate third term remains contested, N4 also receives partial satisfaction. The structure is presented as a general philosophical system, so N5 is clearly satisfied.

None of N1–N4 is judged not satisfied, but their correspondence and integration remain interpretation-dependent. N6 therefore receives partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction.

Limitation of the present comparison: This assessment does not resolve disputes among metaphysical, non-metaphysical, social-institutional, and conceptual interpretations of Hegel. Interpreting objective spirit as a candidate third term with subjective status is itself interpretation-dependent.

4.5.3 Criterion-Level Summary: German Idealism

Thinker	N1	N2	N3	N4	N5	N6
Schelling	P	P	P	P	C	P
Hegel	P	P	P	P	C	P

Table 8. Criterion-level assessments: German Idealism.

C = clear satisfaction; P = partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction; N = non-satisfaction; I = insufficient evidence.

4.6 Process Ontology and Phenomenology

This section examines Nishida Kitarō, Alfred North Whitehead, and Maurice Merleau-Ponty. All three criticized the view that isolated substance constitutes the ultimate unit of ontology, but they approached relation and becoming from different starting points: place, event, and body, respectively.

4.6.1 Nishida Kitarō

Textual Evidence. Nishida’s early philosophy begins from pure experience, understood as experience prior to the reflective separation of subject and object. *An Inquiry into the Good* develops this account through its initial analysis of pure experience and its subsequent discussion of intellectual intuition (Nishida 1990, 3–10, 30–32).

The essay “Basho” introduces place not as an independently existing container but as that within which judgments and the distinction between subject and predicate, or subject and object, become possible. Its successive forms culminate in the place of absolute nothingness,

which is not treated as one being opposed to other beings (Nishida 2012, 49–102; Krummel 2015).

In “Logic and Life,” Nishida applies the logic of place to social existence and the historical world. Individuals act upon and form the historical world while their activity is simultaneously conditioned by that world. Nishida describes this structure through reciprocal determination rather than through a unidirectional relation between an independently constituted subject and an external environment (Nishida 2012, 103–174; see also Nishida 1970). His final essay develops the standpoint of absolute nothingness in relation to religious self-awareness, while retaining the irreducibility of the world of historical existence (Nishida 1987, 47–123).

These writings belong to distinct phases of Nishida’s development and should not be treated as one unchanged system (Krummel 2015).

Interpretive Reconstruction. In Nishida’s structure, self and world do not precede their relation as isolated substances; they arise within the self-determination of place. The reciprocal determination of individual and historical world is not a unidirectional causal relation, but a dynamic structure in which each is a condition for the constitution of the other.

Place or absolute nothingness, however, is not a third subjectivity generated through the intersection of two differentiated subjectivities. It functions instead as the encompassing field that makes possible the differentiation of subject and object, individual and world.

Structural Assessment. The relational field and reciprocal determination provide partial correspondence under N1–N3, although the subjective status of the candidate third term is not clear. Place has an ontological role, but not reality as a third subjectivity; N4 therefore receives partial satisfaction. Since the structure is presented as a general ontology, N5 is clearly satisfied.

None of N1–N4 is judged not satisfied, but their correspondence and integration remain interpretation-dependent. N6 therefore receives partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction.

Limitation of the present comparison: Nishida’s pure experience, logic of place, absolute nothingness, and theory of the historical world belong to multiple phases of his thought. Mapping reciprocal determination onto a third-subjectivity structure involves interpretive distance.

4.6.2 Alfred North Whitehead

Textual Evidence. In *Process and Reality*, actual entities or actual occasions are defined not as enduring substances but as processes of becoming. Prehension names the relation through which a new actual occasion takes up and feels elements of antecedent reality. In concrescence, many data are formed into a new unity. Once completed, the actual occasion becomes an objective datum for subsequent becoming (Whitehead 1978, 18–29, 210–215).

Enduring objects, living organisms, and persons are understood not as unchanging substrates, but as organized societies or series of actual occasions. Stability is explained through inherited order and repetition rather than through a substance that arrests becoming.

Interpretive Reconstruction. In Whitehead’s ontology, relation is not something added after the completion of substance. An actual occasion becomes a new subject through its

relations with an antecedent world. A structure in which relation generates a new subjective unity is therefore clearly present.

Concrescence, however, ordinarily integrates many antecedent data rather than constituting the intersection of two differentiated subjectivities. Its temporal direction is also asymmetrical: a later actual occasion does not reconstitute the completed antecedent occasions from which it arises.

Structural Assessment. Because relation gives rise to a new subjective unity, N1 and N2 receive partial correspondence. A later occasion is affected by the antecedent world and conditions subsequent processes, but it does not reconstitute the completed antecedent occasions from which it arises; N3 is therefore not satisfied.

An actual occasion is not merely a relational pattern or an observer's description, but an ontological unit technically defined as a subject in becoming. N4 is therefore clearly satisfied. This assessment concerns its ontological status and does not imply that an actual occasion is identical to Intersection Subjectivity in SIO.

Since the structure is a general ontological principle, N5 is also clearly satisfied. Because N3 is not satisfied, N6 is not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: In Whitehead, "subject" is a technical term for the becoming phase of an actual occasion. It cannot be identified without qualification with a human conscious subject or with subjectivity in SIO.

4.6.3 Maurice Merleau-Ponty

Textual Evidence. The *Phenomenology of Perception* treats the body not merely as an object but as a bodily subject that perceives and acts in the world (Merleau-Ponty 2012). In the later *The Visible and the Invisible*, Flesh, chiasm, and reversibility are introduced to describe the relations between seer and seen, toucher and touched, and self and other (Merleau-Ponty 1968, 130–155).

Intercorporeality describes a structure in which embodied subjects belong to a shared sensible world and become mutually intelligible through gesture, action, and perception. Reversibility indicates that activity and passivity, perceiver and perceived, are not two wholly separate domains, while preserving their difference.

Interpretive Reconstruction. For Merleau-Ponty, subject and world, self and other, do not first exist as fully independent substances and only subsequently enter into relation. The embodied subject is always already embedded in a perceptual and sensible world. Flesh is the ontological field or element that makes this reversibility and intertwining possible.

Flesh, however, is not a third subjectivity generated through the intersection of two subjectivities. It is instead described as a prior ontological dimension that makes possible the intertwining of multiple subjects and the world.

Structural Assessment. N1 is not satisfied because Flesh is not presented as a third subjectivity. Chiasm and mutual constitution provide partial correspondence under N2. Transformation of subjects through relation is discussed, but not as the action of a third subjectivity; N3 is therefore not satisfied. Although Flesh has ontological status, it is not a candidate third term of the relevant kind, so N4 is not satisfied. The relational and embodied structure has broad scope, providing partial correspondence under N5. N6 is not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: The later ontology of Flesh and chiasm is found in an unfinished work and working notes. Its systematic position and continuity with the earlier phenomenology remain interpretively uncertain.

4.6.4 Criterion-Level Summary: Process Ontology and Phenomenology

Thinker	N1	N2	N3	N4	N5	N6
Nishida Kitarō	P	P	P	P	C	P
Whitehead	P	P	N	C	C	N
Merleau-Ponty	N	P	N	N	P	N

Table 9. Criterion-level assessments: process ontology and phenomenology.

C = clear satisfaction; P = partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction; N = non-satisfaction; I = insufficient evidence.

4.7 Contemporary Relational Theories

This section examines Participatory Sense-Making in cognitive science, the Analytic Third in psychoanalysis, and cosmopsychism in philosophy of mind. The three originate in different disciplines and do not constitute a single theoretical tradition.

4.7.1 Participatory Sense-Making

Textual Evidence. Participatory Sense-Making, developed by Hanne De Jaegher and Ezequiel Di Paolo, does not explain social cognition solely as inference by isolated individuals concerning the internal states of others. Interaction between autonomous agents may form patterns of coordination and a limited interactional autonomy irreducible to the sum of the participants' intentions (De Jaegher and Di Paolo 2007; De Jaegher, Di Paolo, and Gallagher 2010).

Participants maintain, modify, or terminate the interaction, while the interaction process that arises may itself enable, constrain, and transform the sense-making of each participant. Autonomy here does not mean a persistent substance independent of the participants, but an interaction process possessing a degree of organization and constraint.

Interpretive Reconstruction. On this account, interaction is not merely a channel through which already completed meanings are transmitted. Some meanings arise only through participation, and the interaction process acts back upon individual participants. The structure includes differentiated subjects, constitutive interaction, emergent relational organization, and reciprocal effects.

Interactional autonomy, however, does not imply that the interaction itself becomes a new subjectivity or subject of experience. An autonomous interaction process must be distinguished from an irreducible third subjectivity.

Structural Assessment. N1 is not satisfied because the interaction process is not explicitly assigned subjective status. N2 is clearly satisfied insofar as interaction constitutes meaning. N3 is partially satisfied because the process that arises acts back upon the sense-making of the participants. N4 is not satisfied because the candidate third term is not assigned ontological status as a subjectivity. Since the theory's scope is principally social cognition, N5 receives partial satisfaction. Because N1 and N4 are not satisfied, N6 is not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: Participatory Sense-Making is a theory of social cognition. Deriving subjectivity as an experiencing subject from interactional autonomy would exceed the theory's own explicit claims.

4.7.2 The Analytic Third

Textual Evidence. Thomas Ogden's Analytic Third describes an analytic experience that arises through the relation between analyst and analysand and cannot be attributed exclusively to the private experience of either. The analyst's reveries, affects, bodily sensations, associations, and silences may be interpreted both as personal experiences and as expressions of a process co-generated by the analytic relation (Ogden 1994).

The Analytic Third is not identical to every theory of intersubjectivity or every concept of a psychoanalytic field. Ogden's formulation concerns a particular form of co-generated experience arising within the asymmetrical clinical relation between analyst and analysand.

Interpretive Reconstruction. The Analytic Third arises from the relation between two persons with different roles, histories, and responsibilities. It is neither their average nor a symmetrical compromise. The co-generated analytic field exceeds their conscious intentions and alters what each participant can experience and understand.

This structure includes differentiated subjectivities, a co-generated third experiential structure, and effects of that structure upon both participants. The Analytic Third, however, is not presented as a new independent person or enduring substance. Its status as a subjectivity depends upon a clinical and interpretive context.

Structural Assessment. Because a third experiential structure is co-generated, N1 receives partial and interpretation-dependent correspondence. N2 is clearly satisfied. N3 is also clearly satisfied because the analytic process changes the experience and understanding of both participants. Although the third possesses clinical reality, it is not explicitly presented as an independent ontological subjectivity; N4 therefore receives partial satisfaction. Since the theory is restricted to the analytic situation, N5 is not satisfied. Because N5 is not satisfied, N6 is also not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: Identifying the Analytic Third depends on clinical experience and psychoanalytic interpretation. Extending its ontological status to a general ontology of subjectivity would exceed the scope of the original theory.

4.7.3 Cosmopsychism

Textual Evidence. Cosmopsychism comprises positions in the philosophy of mind according to which the cosmos as a whole possesses consciousness or fundamental subjectivity. In constitutive and priority cosmopsychism, individual conscious subjects are grounded in, constituted by, or otherwise dependent upon facts concerning a cosmic subject (Shani 2015; Nagasawa and Wager 2016; Goff 2017).

This position may avoid the combination problem of explaining how micro-subjects constitute a macro-subject, but it faces the decomposition problem of explaining how multiple finite subjects arise from one cosmic subject. Cosmopsychist theories also differ concerning constitution, grounding, and ontological priority.

Interpretive Reconstruction. Cosmopsychism treats subjectivity as ontologically fundamental and directs explanation from whole to individuals. The cosmic subject is not generated from an aggregate of individual subjects; individual subjects depend upon the cosmic subject.

Its direction of constitution is therefore the reverse of SIO’s generation of a third subjectivity through the intersection of differentiated subjectivities. The cosmic subject is not a third subjectivity arising between two subjectivities.

Structural Assessment. Although the cosmic subject is an irreducible subject, it is not a third subjectivity constituted in relation to two subjectivities. N1 therefore has only limited conceptual similarity and is structurally not satisfied. N2 and N3 are also not satisfied.

Subjectivity is assigned clear ontological reality, but treating the cosmic subject as the candidate third term in a comparison with SIO is itself a limited reconstruction. N4 therefore receives partial satisfaction. Because cosmopsychism is presented as a general ontology of mind, N5 is clearly satisfied. Since N1–N3 are not satisfied, N6 is not satisfied.

Limitation of the present comparison: Cosmopsychism is not a single theory. Constitutive cosmopsychism, priority cosmopsychism, and related forms of Russellian monism differ in their accounts of the constitutive relation between whole and individuals.

4.7.4 Criterion-Level Summary: Contemporary Relational Theories

Theory	N1	N2	N3	N4	N5	N6
Participatory Sense-Making	N	C	P	N	P	N
Analytic Third	P	C	C	P	N	N
Cosmopsychism	N	N	N	P	C	N

Table 10. Criterion-level assessments: contemporary relational theories.

C = clear satisfaction; P = partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction; N = non-satisfaction; I = insufficient evidence.

4.8 Methodological Outcome of This Chapter

For each comparison case, this chapter separated textual evidence, interpretive reconstruction, structural assessment, and a case-specific limitation before applying N1–N6 individually.

At this stage, no overall grade is assigned to any theory, and no integrated conclusion is offered concerning historical precedent or structural proximity to SIO. A case’s clear or partial satisfaction of several criteria is recorded as such, but the significance of that combination for the historical position of SIO cannot be concluded from this chapter alone.

Partial satisfaction of N6 likewise does not mean that the complete structure of SIO has been anticipated. It indicates that none of N1–N5 has been found clearly not satisfied, while satisfaction of the individual criteria or their integration within one ontology remains interpretation-dependent. Confirmation of complete structural conjunction requires clear satisfaction of all of N1–N5.

Chapter 5 compares the criterion-level assessments across cases. At that stage, the analysis evaluates which structures appear across multiple traditions, which combinations of criteria are concentrated in particular theories, and whether the complete structural conjunction of SIO is identifiable within the scope of the review.

What this chapter has assessed is the structural correspondence of the compared ontologies with SIO, not the truth, validity, or historical novelty of SIO itself. The historical position of

SIO is evaluated only in Chapter 5, where the criterion-level assessments obtained here are integrated across cases.

5 Comparative Evaluation

5.1 Purpose and Analytical Scope

Chapter 4 distinguished textual evidence, interpretive reconstruction, and structural assessment for each comparison case and applied N1–N6 individually. The purpose of the present chapter is not to revise or reinterpret those assessments, but to integrate them across the comparison set and describe the structural patterns identified within the scope of the review.

Accordingly, this chapter introduces no new comparison cases, literature, or evaluation criteria. It uses only the assessments fixed in Chapter 4 to examine which structures recur across multiple traditions, which criteria are distributed across different theories, and which combinations are repeatedly absent.

The conclusions of this chapter are restricted to the cases examined in this manuscript. Failure to identify complete structural correspondence here does not establish the absence of a comparable structure from the history of thought as a whole, including philosophical, religious, or intellectual traditions not examined in this study.

N1–N6 were derived from the structure of SIO defined in Chapter 2. This chapter therefore does not reassess SIO itself under N1–N6. The question is how the ontologies examined in Chapter 4 correspond to those criteria.

5.2 Overall Pattern of Criterion-Level Assessments

The assessments established in Chapter 4 are consolidated below.

This table reproduces the assessments from Chapter 4 without alteration and does not add a further layer of evaluation. Because the criteria are not additive scores, the theories cannot be ranked by the number of criteria they satisfy. The following sections instead examine the combinations in which the criteria occur across the comparison set.

5.3 Recurring Structures

5.3.1 Third Terms and Third Subjectivity

N1 asks whether a third term constituted in relation to two subjectivities is treated as a subjectivity irreducible to them. No case examined in Chapter 4 received clear satisfaction for N1.

Partial or interpretation-dependent correspondence was identified in Plotinus, Kashmir Śaivism, Trinitarian ontology, Schelling, Hegel, Nishida, Whitehead, and the Analytic Third. These theories contain triadic structures, unities constituted through relation, derivative subjects, new experiential structures, or relational organizations irreducible to the individual terms involved.

In each case, however, interpretive qualifications remain concerning whether the third term is a subjectivity in the sense defined by SIO. The existence of triadicity, mediation, unity, a relational field, or emergent organization does not by itself establish the existence of an irreducible third subjectivity. The distribution of N1 therefore confirms the need to distinguish the presence of a third term from the presence of a third subjectivity.

	N1	N2	N3	N4	N5	N6
Parmenides	N	N	N	N	N	N
Heraclitus	N	N	N	N	N	N
Plato	N	N	N	N	N	N
Aristotle	N	N	N	N	N	N
Plotinus	P	N	N	P	C	N
Upaniṣads / Advaita	N	N	N	N	N	N
Sāṃkhya / Classical Yoga	N	N	N	N	N	N
Nyāya / Vaiśeṣika	N	N	N	N	N	N
Early Buddhism	N	P	N	N	P	N
Madhyamaka	N	P	N	N	P	N
Jain Philosophy	N	N	N	N	P	N
Kashmir Śaivism	P	P	P	P	C	P
Christian Trinitarian Ontology	P	N	N	C	P	N
Schelling	P	P	P	P	C	P
Hegel	P	P	P	P	C	P
Nishida Kitarō	P	P	P	P	C	P
Whitehead	P	P	N	C	C	N
Merleau-Ponty	N	P	N	N	P	N
Participatory Sense-Making	N	C	P	N	P	N
Analytic Third	P	C	C	P	N	N
Cosmopsychism	N	N	N	P	C	N

N = non-satisfaction **P** = partial or interpretation-dependent **C** = clear satisfaction **I** = insufficient evidence

Figure 4. Distribution of criterion-level assessments across the comparison set. Rows follow the order of the historical review. The categories are non-additive and do not rank the philosophical value or historical importance of the comparison cases. N6 is separated visually because it assesses the conjunction of N1–N5. P retains the single category defined in Chapter 3; its case-specific grounds are reported separately in Chapter 4.

5.3.2 Generation Through Intersection

Participatory Sense-Making and the Analytic Third received clear satisfaction for N2. Both treat relation or interaction not as an external channel through which already constituted content is transmitted, but as a constitutive process through which new meaning or experience arises.

Partial correspondence with N2 was identified in early Buddhism, Madhyamaka, Kashmir Śaivism, Schelling, Hegel, Nishida, Whitehead, and Merleau-Ponty. Through dependent constitution, dynamic generation, mediation, reciprocal determination, concrescence, or chiasm, these theories indicate that what exists is not always fully constituted independently of relation.

The constitutive character of relation is nevertheless not identical to the generation of a third subjectivity through the intersection of two differentiated subjectivities. The distribution of N2—partial correspondence across several theories but clear satisfaction in only two contemporary cases—therefore supports the distinction between relation in general and the specific direction of generation through intersection.

5.3.3 Action upon the Originating Subjectivities

Only the Analytic Third received clear satisfaction for N3. In this case, the co-generated analytic process alters the experience and understanding of both analyst and analysand as part of the structure described by the theory.

Partial correspondence was identified in Kashmir Śaivism, Schelling, Hegel, Nishida, and Participatory Sense-Making. In these cases, manifestation, generated forms, institutions, the historical world, or an interaction process acts upon finite subjects or participants and changes their modes of organization or understanding.

Interpretive limitations remain, however, concerning whether this action proceeds from a third subjectivity constituted through intersection. Transformation, interaction, and reorganization may occur without constituting the reconstitution of originating subjectivities by a third subjectivity.

5.3.4 Ontological Status of the Candidate Third Term

Trinitarian ontology and Whitehead received clear satisfaction for N4. In Trinitarian ontology, the Holy Spirit is formulated as the third hypostasis possessing full divine reality. In Whitehead, the actual occasion is not merely a descriptive construction but has ontological status as a subject in becoming.

Clear satisfaction of N4 does not entail satisfaction of N1 or N2. In Trinitarian ontology, the third hypostasis is not a subjectivity newly generated through intersection. Whitehead's actual occasion is likewise not ordinarily defined as a third subjectivity arising through the intersection of two differentiated subjectivities.

Plotinus, Kashmir Śaivism, Schelling, Hegel, Nishida, the Analytic Third, and cosmopsychism received partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction for N4. In these cases, some reality is attributed to the candidate third term or to subjectivity, but it remains interpretation-dependent which term should function as the candidate third or whether its reality extends to general ontological subjectivity.

This distribution confirms that the ontological reality of a third term must be assessed independently of both its subjective status and its direction of generation.

5.3.5 General Theoretical Scope

Plotinus, Kashmir Śaivism, Schelling, Hegel, Nishida, Whitehead, and cosmopsychism received clear satisfaction for N5. These theories present general structures concerning being, consciousness, nature, spirit, events, or cosmic subjectivity rather than restricting their accounts to a particular interpersonal relation or individual case.

Early Buddhism, Madhyamaka, Jain philosophy, Trinitarian ontology, Merleau-Ponty, and Participatory Sense-Making received partial satisfaction. These theories may have broad scope, but the particular structure compared in Chapter 4 is not univocally presented as a general ontology of subjectivity corresponding to SIO.

The Analytic Third, by contrast, clearly satisfied N2 and N3 but did not satisfy N5 because its domain is restricted to the psychoanalytic situation. This result illustrates that structural proximity and theoretical generality are distinct dimensions of comparison.

5.4 Distribution of Criteria and Recurrently Absent Conjunctions

The results of Chapter 4 do not indicate that the elements associated with N1–N5 were absent from earlier thought. Rather, those elements appear in distributed form across multiple traditions.

Triadic structures and the reality of third terms appear in Plotinus and Trinitarian ontology. Dependent constitution and constitutive relation occur in Buddhist thought, phenomenology, German Idealism, process philosophy, and Participatory Sense-Making. An experiential structure generated through relation and acting upon its participants appears with particular clarity in the Analytic Third. Structures that treat subjectivity as a general ontological principle are present in Kashmir Śaivism, German Idealism, Whitehead, and cosmopsychism.

These elements are not, however, integrated in the same way within a single theory. Chapter 4 revealed several recurrent separations.

First, where a candidate third term receives clear ontological reality, that term tends not to be generated through intersection. In Trinitarian ontology, the Holy Spirit is an eternal third hypostasis rather than something emerging from an intersection of Father and Son. In Whitehead, a new subjective unity arises through relation, but the process is not formulated as an intersection of two differentiated subjectivities and does not reconstitute the completed antecedent occasions from which it arises.

Second, where generation through interaction or intersection is clear, the ontological subjectivity or general scope of the generated third term tends to remain limited. In Participatory Sense-Making, interaction constitutes meaning and acts upon the participants, but the interaction process itself is not defined as a subjectivity. In the Analytic Third, the co-generated third experiential structure and its effects upon the participants are clear, but its ontological status remains interpretation-dependent and its theoretical scope is restricted to the analytic situation.

Third, theories with the scope of a general ontology do not clearly formulate at least one among intersection, third subjectivity, and action upon the originating subjectivities.

Plotinus, Kashmir Śaivism, Schelling, Hegel, Nishida, Whitehead, and cosmopsychism all clearly satisfied N5, but none clearly satisfied all of N1–N4.

The principal difference across the comparison set therefore does not consist merely in the presence or absence of individual elements. What matters is how the subjective status of the third term, its direction of generation, its action upon the originating subjectivities, its ontological reality, and the theoretical scope of the structure are integrated within a single account.

5.5 Cross-Case Assessment of N6

N6 is not an additional criterion independent of N1–N5. It is the conjunction condition assessing whether they are integrated within a single general ontology.

None of the cases examined in Chapter 4 received clear satisfaction for N6. Kashmir Śaivism, Schelling, Hegel, and Nishida received partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction. Every other case received non-satisfaction for N6 because at least one of N1–N5 was not satisfied.

The four cases receiving partial satisfaction for N6 share a common assessment pattern. Each received partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction for N1–N4 and clear satisfaction for N5. Each therefore presents a general ontology with some correspondence concerning third subjectivity, generation through intersection, action upon originating subjectivities, and the ontological status of the candidate third term.

None of those correspondences, however, reached clear satisfaction for each of N1–N4. Moreover, integrating multiple phases of thought, concepts, or triadic structures into a single structure corresponding to SIO remained interpretation-dependent. Partial satisfaction of N6 therefore cannot be treated as a complete structural anticipation of SIO.

No comparison case examined in Chapter 4 clearly satisfied all of N1–N5 and integrated them within a single general ontology.

Proposition 5.1. Absence of Clear Structural Equivalence within the Comparative Set

Let $\mathcal{H}$ denote the set of comparison cases examined in Chapter 4. Let N1–N5, as defined in Chapter 3, designate the structural requirements of SIO, and let N6 designate the conjunction condition assessing their integration within a single general ontology.

Under the definition established in Chapter 3, identifying a comparison case as clearly structurally equivalent to SIO requires clear satisfaction of N1–N5 and clear satisfaction of N6 as their conjunction condition.

Under the assessments fixed in Chapter 4,

$$\forall h \in \mathcal{H}, \quad N_6(h) \neq \text{Clear}.$$

Consequently, no comparison case is identified as a clear structural equivalent to SIO within the examined set; in particular, no case clearly satisfies N1–N5 and integrates them within a single general ontology.

Proof. No comparison case in the criterion-level assessments of Chapter 4 received clear satisfaction for N6.

Kashmir Śaivism, Schelling, Hegel, and Nishida received partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction for N6. Each of these cases, however, received only partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction for N1–N4 and therefore did not clearly satisfy all of N1–N5.

Every comparison case other than these four failed to satisfy at least one of N1–N5 and was consequently assessed as not satisfying N6 under the conjunction rule established in Chapter 3.

It follows that

$$\neg \exists h \in \mathcal{H} \quad N_6(h) = \text{Clear}.$$

Because Chapter 3 establishes clear satisfaction of N6 as a necessary condition for identifying clear structural equivalence, no clear structural equivalent to SIO is identified within the comparison set $\mathcal{H}$. $\square$

Corollary 5.1. Distribution of Constituent Structures

Clear or partial correspondences to individual structures represented by N1–N5 are distributed across multiple theories within $\mathcal{H}$. They are not, however, conjoined within a single comparison case in a form that clearly satisfies all of N1–N5.

Corollary 5.2. Non-identification of SIO as a Merely Terminological Restatement

Within the set of cases examined in Chapter 4, no comparison case is identified as a clear structural equivalent to SIO. On the basis of the present comparison, SIO therefore cannot be identified as a merely terminological restatement of any one theory within the comparison set.

Scope of Application

Proposition 5.1 and its corollaries are relative to the comparison cases examined in Chapter 4, the criteria defined in Chapter 3, and the textual interpretations and structural assessments fixed in Chapter 4.

They do not establish the absolute historical novelty of SIO across traditions not examined in this manuscript. Nor do they establish its philosophical superiority, truth, conceptual coherence, or empirical validity.

5.6 The Structural Position of SIO within the Examined Comparison Set

Proposition 5.1 establishes that the comparison set examined in Chapter 4 contains no case identified as a clear structural equivalent to SIO—that is, no case that clearly satisfies N1–N5 and integrates them within a single general ontology. Within the scope of the comparison, SIO therefore cannot be identified as a merely terminological restatement of any one previously examined theory.

This result does not deny partial or interpretation-dependent structural correspondence. The partial satisfaction of N6 by Kashmir Śaivism, Schelling, Hegel, and Nishida indicates that several structures associated with SIO may be integrated in specific ways within each of these ontologies.

What Proposition 5.1 excludes is not the existence of such correspondence, but the identification of clear structural equivalence under the assessments presently established. Partial satisfaction of N6 is therefore retained not as proof of non-equivalence, but as structural proximity requiring further textual and interpretive examination.

The synthesis does not support the conclusion that the individual elements constituting SIO lack historical precedents. Third terms, triadicity, relational constitution, emergence, reciprocal transformation, the ontological reality of subjectivity, and general ontology have each been developed in different traditions.

Within the examined comparison set, the structural position of SIO lies not in introducing each of these elements independently, but in integrating the following within a single ontological formulation:

- differentiated subjectivities;
- constitutive intersection;
- an irreducible third subjectivity arising through intersection;
- action of the third subjectivity upon the originating subjectivities;
- the ontological reality of the third subjectivity; and
- the general theoretical scope of this structure.

Neither Proposition 5.1 nor Corollary 5.2 entails that SIO is the first ontology in the history of thought, universally unique, or more adequate than other ontologies.

First, the comparison set is not exhaustive. Second, the individual assessments retain interpretive uncertainty concerning the selection of texts, reconstruction of concepts, and application of the criteria. Third, structural distinction from the examined theories does not establish the conceptual coherence, truth, or empirical validity of SIO.

The conclusion supported by this chapter is narrower. Within the comparison set examined in this manuscript, structures corresponding to N1–N5 appear in distributed form across several traditions, but no comparison case clearly satisfied all of them and integrated them within a single general ontology.

In this limited sense, SIO may be situated not as a merely terminological restatement of any one examined theory, but as a distinguishable ontological research program that integrates previously distributed elements according to a specific direction of constitution and conjunction.

This positioning is a limited structural assessment derived from historical comparison, not an argument requiring the adoption of SIO. Its philosophical adequacy, conceptual coherence, formalizability, and empirical applicability must be examined independently of its structural relation to the historical comparison set.

6 Philosophical Implications and Research Program

6.1 Scope of This Chapter

Chapter 4 examined the structural correspondence between SIO and major historical and contemporary ontologies under N1–N6. Chapter 5 integrated those assessments without altering them and situated SIO structurally within the examined comparison set.

The role of the present chapter is not to continue the historical comparison. Nor is it to interpret Proposition 5.1 as a demonstration of the truth, absolute novelty, or philosophical superiority of SIO. This chapter takes SIO, as defined in Chapter 2, as an ontological proposal and examines its philosophical implications, conceptual difficulties, and future research tasks.

The discussion distinguishes ontological claims, formal hypotheses, and empirical claims. Implications derived conceptually from the internal definition of SIO are not identical to hypotheses used to represent that structure mathematically. Nor would the construction of a formal model by itself demonstrate the empirical reality of third subjectivity. Empirical claims require independent operational definitions, methods of observation, and conditions of failure.

6.2 Reframing Subjectivity and Objectivity

SIO defines subjectivity as perspective. Under this definition, subjectivity is not restricted to a psychological state or private representation enclosed within an individual. Subjectivity is a perspective from which existence constitutes itself and other existents from a determinate position and orientation.

This definition requires reconsideration of the division between subjectivity and objectivity as mutually exclusive domains. SIO does not, however, simply identify objectivity with Relative Subjectivity. Nor does it reduce objectivity to an arbitrary collection of subjective perspectives.

What is ordinarily called objectivity may be reconsidered not as a “view from nowhere” from which perspective has been entirely removed, but as a description, relation, or structure that maintains a degree of stability across different perspectives. Stability across perspectives does not necessarily mean independence from perspective. It may instead be constituted through transformations, correspondences, mutual constraints, or intersections among perspectives.

In this sense, SIO reorganizes the opposition between subjectivity and objectivity through the structure of Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity. Relative Subjectivity is differentiated through the projection of Absolute Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity emerges in the interval between them. Difference is not added to primordial unity from outside; it arises as a single existence gives perspective to itself.

This reconstruction changes not only the proposed account of objectivity but also the formulation of the philosophical problem. The question is not only what remains after subjective perspectives have been removed. It must also concern which relations multiple perspectives form, which structures remain stable across perspectives, and what may be constituted anew through those relations.

SIO does not yet provide a completed theory of objectivity. How stability, transformability, and invariance across perspectives should be defined remains a task for future conceptual and formal research.

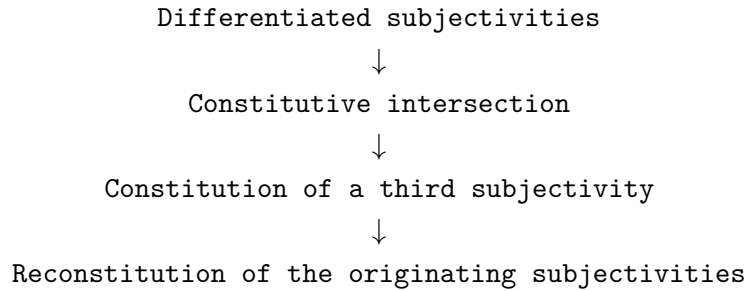
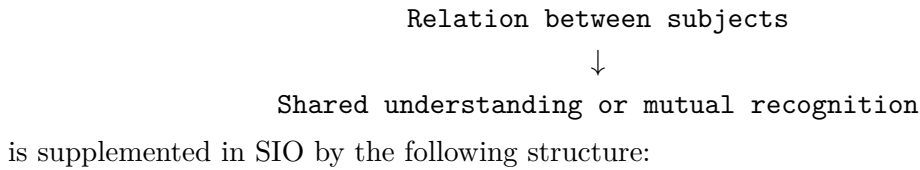
6.3 Distinguishing Intersubjectivity from Third Subjectivity

Intersubjectivity is not a single theory and carries different meanings in phenomenology, social philosophy, psychology, psychoanalysis, and cognitive science. In general terms, it may be understood as a family of concepts addressing understanding between multiple subjects, shared meaning, mutual recognition, interaction, or the constitution of a common world (Husserl 1960; Schutz 1967; Zahavi 2001; Thompson 2007).

SIO intersects with the domain of intersubjectivity insofar as it concerns relational structures that cannot be explained through isolated subjects alone. The structure proposed by SIO, however, is not limited to describing understanding or shared content between subjects.

In SIO, the third subjectivity constituted through intersection is neither a state in which A and B share identical content, nor the average of their views, nor an observer's description of their mutual understanding. It is defined as a subjectivity constituted through the constitutive intersection of differentiated subjectivities, irreducible to either originating subjectivity, and capable of acting back upon both.

Where intersubjectivity principally describes relations among subjects, SIO therefore proposes a generative ontology in which intersection may constitute a further subjectivity.



This distinction does not imply that theories of intersubjectivity are deficient in comparison with SIO. They answer different questions. Theories of intersubjectivity ask about the conditions of understanding, a shared world, or mutual recognition among subjects. SIO asks whether intersection among subjects may itself be constituted as a new subjectivity.

6.4 Relation, Emergence, and Third Subjectivity

SIO assigns ontological significance to relation, but this alone does not make it identical to relational ontology in general. The reality of relations, the constitution of entities through relations, or the priority of relation over relata is not sufficient to establish the complete structure of SIO.

The distinctive question posed by SIO is whether relation may generate a new third subjectivity. Relation must not merely connect two subjects; through the constitution of the relation itself, a subjectivity irreducible to either must arise.

SIO must likewise be distinguished from emergentism in general. Emergentist theories address the generation of a new whole, property, function, or organization from the combination of components. The emergence of a new property or function does not by itself establish that what emerges is a subjectivity (Bedau and Humphreys 2008).

The structure of SIO includes at least the following conditions:

- what emerges is a subjectivity;
- that subjectivity is irreducible to the originating subjectivities;
- it is generated through intersection;
- the generated third subjectivity acts back upon the originating subjectivities; and
- the structure is proposed as a general ontology rather than as an account limited to a particular case.

SIO therefore integrates not merely the reality of relation and the occurrence of emergence, but the generation of subjectivity through relation and the reconstitution of the originating subjectivities by the generated third subjectivity.

As Chapter 5 established, structures corresponding to these components are distributed across multiple theories in the comparison set. The purpose of the present section is not to repeat that historical assessment, but to clarify the philosophical significance of their integration within a single ontological formulation in SIO.

6.5 Philosophical Meaning of $AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB$ Closure

As defined in Chapter 2, $AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB$ is the canonical operational form concerning multiple Relative Subjectivities. It does not replace the ontological prototype consisting of Absolute Subjectivity, Relative Subjectivity, and Intersection Subjectivity. The present section maintains this distinction while examining the philosophical meaning of $AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB$ closure.

A and B do not generate C and thereby bring the process to an end. The constitution of C changes the relation in which A and B stand and may alter their meanings, boundaries, and possibilities for action.

This structure differs from unidirectional generation.

$$A + B \rightarrow C$$

would leave C as a result arising from A and B. By contrast,

$$AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB$$

indicates that the constitution of C acts back upon A and B and reconstitutes the originating subjectivities.

This action is not restricted to information transmission or external feedback. What SIO addresses is ontological reconstitution: the modes of existence of A and B are reorganized through the generated third subjectivity. More precisely, the structure may be described as reciprocal reconstitution through the generated third subjectivity.

This closure requires reconsideration of the assumption that self-identity is fully fixed prior to relation. A and B exist as differentiated subjectivities before their intersection, but A and B after intersection need not retain exactly the same relational and semantic organization that they possessed beforehand.

A and B do not, however, dissolve into C. The constitution of C does not erase the difference between the originating subjectivities; it reconstitutes them while preserving that difference. If A and B ceased to be distinguishable, the difference required for intersection would itself disappear.

The $AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB$ closure therefore contains both the preservation of difference and ontological reconstitution.

6.6 Unity, Difference, and Multiplicity

The problem of the one and the many asks how difference may arise from unity and how multiple existents may form a single order or whole.

SIO adopts neither a model in which an external force divides the one into many nor one in which the many are ultimately reduced to the one. In SIO, a single existence may internally contain the perspective that gives itself to itself, the perspective that receives itself from itself, and the perspective that closes the intersection of the two.

At the level of multiple Relative Subjectivities, differentiated perspectives intersect, and a third unity is constituted through that intersection. This third unity is not a higher one that erases the originating differences. C presupposes the difference between A and B, is constituted through that difference, and reconstitutes them within a new relation.

In this sense, SIO proposes unity without the erasure of difference.

Unity
 $\neq$ absence of difference

Unification
 $\neq$ elimination of multiplicity

Unity in SIO does not mean making differentiated perspectives identical. It means that a new subjective unity is constituted through their intersection.

It has not yet been shown, however, that this structure provides a complete resolution of the classical problem of the one and the many. Further explanation is required concerning both the conditions under which internal perspectival difference arises from primordial unity and the conditions under which multiple Intersection Subjectivities may form higher-order unity.

6.7 Individuation and Identity of Generated Subjectivities

If a third subjectivity can be constituted, questions arise concerning its individuation and identity.

Do A and B remain the same subjectivities after the constitution of C? In what sense are the reconstituted A and B identical to A and B before intersection? Is C an independent individual distinct from A and B, or a relational individual that exists only so long as the relation between A and B continues?

The conditions for the persistence of C must also be clarified.

- Does C persist after the intersection of A and B ends?
- Does its persistence require continuing interaction or memory?
- If the same A and B intersect again, is the same C reconstituted?
- Or does every intersection generate a new C?
- If A or B changes substantially, is the identity of C preserved?
- Can C have more than two originating subjectivities?

These are not merely terminological questions. If a third subjectivity is an ontological reality, an account is required of what distinguishes one third subjectivity from another and what preserves its identity over time.

SIO therefore requires a theory of individuation for generated subjectivities.

Such a theory must avoid explaining individuation solely through an invariant substrate while also avoiding reduction to a transient pattern of interaction. Persistent organization, the history of the relation, maintenance of closure, action upon the originating subjectivities, and distinction from other third subjectivities are possible candidate conditions.

These conditions are not yet settled. This indeterminacy does not refute SIO, but it is one of the principal reasons why SIO should be understood as a research program rather than a completed ontology.

6.8 Temporality, Causality, and Reconstitution

The $AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB$ structure requires careful distinctions concerning temporal order and causation.

The statement that C is constituted through the intersection of A and B and acts upon them does not imply that a temporally later C alters the past physical states of A and B. Ontological reconstitution in SIO must be distinguished from simple physical retrocausality.

After the constitution of C, what may change is the present organization, mutual relation, meaning, self-understanding, or range of action of A and B. The existence of C may also alter how A and B understand their respective pasts. Reinterpretation of the past, however, is not identical to alteration of past physical events.

At least three possibilities must therefore be distinguished:

1. changes in the present states of A and B after the constitution of C;
2. reinterpretation of the histories and self-understandings of A and B; and
3. retrocausal action upon past physical states themselves.

N3 in this manuscript does not imply physical retrocausality. As defined in Chapter 3, N3 concerns the reconstitution of the present organization, perspectives, relations, actions, or modes of existence of A and B following the constitution of C. Reinterpretation of history or self-understanding may accompany such reconstitution, but action upon past physical states is not included in the definition of N3.

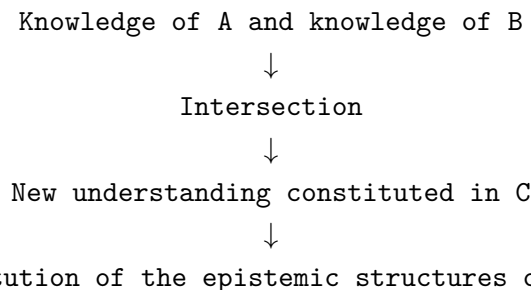
Ontological reconstitution must therefore not be conflated with physical retrocausality. Future formalization must distinguish temporal order, state updating, historical dependence, and causal direction explicitly.

6.9 Epistemological Implications

If the structure proposed by SIO is applied to epistemology, knowledge may not be exhaustively explained as the representation of an object by an isolated subject.

Through the intersection of A and B, an understanding may be constituted in C that existed in neither subjectivity alone. Knowledge constituted in C may not be a simple aggregation of the prior knowledge of A and B, but a new epistemic structure incorporating their difference, correspondence, tension, and transformability.

If the understanding constituted in C acts back upon A and B, it may also alter what each can know, which relations each regards as relevant, and which distinctions each employs. The generation of knowledge would then have the following closure:



Knowledge constituted in a third subjectivity is not identical to collective knowledge, agreement, shared belief, or majority judgment. Multiple subjects may agree on the same proposition without constituting an irreducible third subjectivity. Conversely, the constitution of a third subjectivity need not require A and B to agree about every matter.

Agreement does not guarantee truth. SIO cannot treat content generated through the intersection of perspectives as true merely because of its mode of generation. Knowledge constituted in a third subjectivity remains subject to standards such as coherence, falsifiability, correspondence with its object, explanatory power, or examination from other perspectives.

An epistemological development of SIO therefore requires not only a theory of how knowledge is constituted in a third subjectivity, but also an account of its conditions of justification and fallibility.

6.10 Ethical Implications

No determinate ethical norm follows directly from SIO. Deriving a conclusion about what ought to be done from a description of ontological structure requires further argument across the distinction between being and obligation.

SIO may nevertheless suggest the possibility of an ethics that does not treat the other merely as an object.

Intersection in SIO is neither the projection of one's own perspective onto the other nor the assimilation of the other into oneself. Intersection requires A and B to remain differentiated subjectivities whose perspectives are not reduced to one another.

If this structure is developed ethically, "viewing the other from the other's perspective" may function as a principle for resisting the interpretation of another's experience solely

through one's own established framework. It must not, however, be assumed that one subject can fully possess the perspective of another. The other's perspective retains an alterity that exceeds its representation by oneself.

Nor is intersection equivalent to coerced agreement. An apparent unity formed through domination, assimilation, manipulation, or submission must be distinguished from constitutive intersection that preserves the autonomy of differentiated subjectivities.

The conditions below are not proposed as ontological conditions necessary for the constitution of a third subjectivity itself. They are ethical conditions that arise when intersection among human or artificial subjects is intentionally promoted, maintained, or used. The ontological question of whether SIO may apply to natural, nonhuman, or non-intentional intersections must be distinguished from these normative conditions.

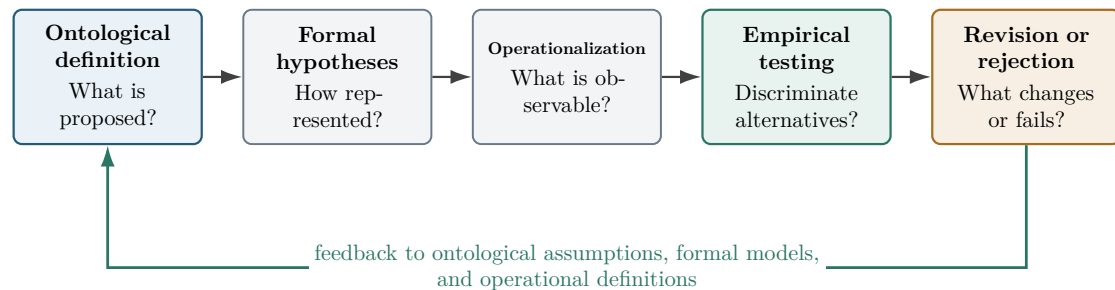
Ethical evaluation of the generation of a third subjectivity in practices involving human or artificial subjects must address at least the following:

- the freedom of the originating subjectivities;
- consent to intersection;
- preservation of perspectival difference;
- exclusion of domination by one subjectivity over another;
- the possibility of withdrawal from the intersection; and
- the legitimacy of constraints imposed upon the originating subjectivities by the generated third subjectivity.

The ethical development of SIO therefore requires an independent normative theory of alterity, freedom, consent, and non-domination. An ontology may open an ethical possibility without proving a particular ethics.

6.11 Formal and Empirical Research Program

Developing SIO from a conceptual proposal into an examinable research program requires separate work on formalization, operationalization, and empirical testing.



No formalization, operationalization, or empirical result, by itself, validates the ontological proposal.

Figure 5. SIO as a formal and empirical research program. Ontological definition, formalization, operationalization, and empirical testing remain distinct stages. Empirical results may require revision or rejection of an operational hypothesis, formal model, or ontological assumption.

6.11.1 Formalization

The first task of formalization is to determine the state spaces or structures through which A, B, and C should be represented.

The simplest representation might take the form

$$C = F(A, B).$$

This expression alone, however, may fail to represent the history and direction of intersection, closure, the irreducibility of C, and the action of C upon A and B.

A history-dependent representation might instead take the form

$$C_t = F(A_t, B_t, H_{AB,t}),$$

where $H_{AB,t}$ denotes the history of the relation between A and B up to time t . This is a formal hypothesis for future investigation, not the ontological definition of SIO itself.

The reconstitution of A and B by C may be represented schematically as

$$A_{t+1} = G_A(A_t, C_t),$$

$$B_{t+1} = G_B(B_t, C_t).$$

Future formal research must address at least the following:

- the state spaces of A, B, and C;
- the definition of an intersection function;
- historical dependence;
- the irreducibility of C;
- conditions of closure;
- stability and instability;
- conditions for the persistence of C;
- recursive third subjectivities;
- extension to multiple subjectivities; and
- inheritance of structure across different scales.

Formal models may clarify SIO and identify contradictions, ambiguities, and hidden assumptions. Formal consistency does not, however, demonstrate ontological reality.

6.11.2 Operationalization

Operationalization must determine the observables, behavioral indicators, or dynamic structures through which a third subjectivity could be identified.

Synchronization, correlation, shared information, averaging, responses to common input, or identical transformation rules are not sufficient evidence of a third subjectivity. Such

phenomena may indicate organized relations between A and B, but they do not establish that the relation is a new subjectivity.

Candidate operational requirements may include:

- organization irreducible to models of either A or B alone;
- states not predictable from a simple composition of A and B;
- dependence upon the history of the relation;
- directed action from C to A and B;
- organization lost when C is removed or disrupted; and
- a degree of robustness across observers or methods of measurement.

Even if these requirements were met, subjectivity itself would not thereby be proven. Functional autonomy, causal influence, and subjectivity as a subject of experience must be distinguished.

SIO therefore requires not only operational indicators of a third subjectivity but also independent criteria specifying what counts as subjectivity.

6.11.3 Empirical Testing

Operational hypotheses associated with SIO may be examinable in several domains:

- human–human interaction;
- social cognition and joint tasks;
- EEG and other neurophysiological measurements;
- inter-brain synchronization and directed interaction (Hasson et al. 2012; Babiloni and Astolfi 2014);
- human–AI interaction;
- systems composed of multiple artificial agents; and
- collective decision-making and collaborative learning.

The observation of synchronization, correlation, or information sharing alone would not support SIO. Empirical tests must compare models of A and B in isolation, simple composition models, common-input models, averaging models, and models of ordinary direct interaction.

Connections to physical or quantum systems do not follow directly from the generality claimed by SIO. Any such connection must be treated as an independent hypothesis specifying its variables, state spaces, interactions, observables, and falsification conditions, rather than as a consequence of philosophical analogy alone.

6.12 Falsifiability and Conditions of Failure

Because SIO is an ontological research program, the entire proposal may not be falsifiable by a single experiment. Individual formal and empirical claims derived from SIO must nevertheless have explicit conditions of failure.

An operational hypothesis associated with SIO would fail to receive empirical support if, for example:

- the structure designated C were adequately explained as a simple composition of A and B;
- no independent organization, state, or persistence could be identified in C;
- the apparent C structure were explained by common input or observational averaging;
- the action attributed to C upon A or B were adequately explained by ordinary direct interaction;
- positing C produced no improvement in prediction or explanation;
- an alternative model without a third subjectivity explained the same data more simply and accurately;
- the result depended upon the measurement method, analytical procedure, or arbitrary parameter selection; or
- the result failed to replicate across independent data or conditions.

What would initially be rejected in such cases is the particular operationalization, formal model, or empirical hypothesis. Failure in a particular experiment would not immediately eliminate every ontological possibility associated with SIO.

If every failure were dismissed as a defect of operationalization, however, SIO would become empirically untestable. Each empirical study must therefore distinguish in advance which results would support a particular hypothesis, which would reject it, and which would remain indeterminate.

If positing a third subjectivity provides no additional explanatory power over a theory that does not include one, the posit is theoretically redundant at least within the domain under examination. This explanatory failure is another important condition of failure that the SIO research program must accept.

6.13 Open Problems

If SIO is treated as a research program rather than a completed ontology, its open problems must be made explicit rather than excluded from the theory.

The principal open problems include the following.

6.13.1 Individuation of Third Subjectivities

What distinguishes one C from another? Is the identity of C determined by the originating subjectivities, the history of intersection, the structure of closure, or persistent organization?

6.13.2 Criteria of Subjectivity

How are functional autonomy, information integration, causal influence, self-reference, perspective, and experience related? By what criteria can a third term be identified as a subjectivity rather than merely an organization?

6.13.3 Persistence and Dissolution of C

Does C persist after intersection has ended? What conditions are required for C to persist or dissolve? Can a dormant C be distinguished from one that no longer exists?

6.13.4 Competition and Integration among Multiple Cs

Can the same A or B participate simultaneously in multiple Intersection Subjectivities? What structure arises when different Cs impose incompatible reconstitutions upon the same originating subjectivity? Can multiple Cs form a higher-order Intersection Subjectivity?

6.13.5 Recursive Third Subjectivities

If a generated C participates in another intersection as a new Relative Subjectivity, how should the resulting hierarchy be defined? Does recursion continue without limit, or are there conditions of closure or stabilization?

6.13.6 Inheritance across Scales

Can the same structure be applied among individuals, groups, artificial agents, or different physical scales? How is subjectivity at one scale inherited or transformed at another?

6.13.7 Correspondence between Formal Models and Ontology

How do states, variables, functions, or network structures in a mathematical model correspond to subjectivity, perspective, intersection, and closure in SIO? How can formal representation be connected to ontology without identifying the representation with the ontology itself?

6.13.8 Empirical Indicators

Which observables would indicate the constitution of C, and which would indicate only synchronization, shared information, or common input? Through which interventions could the irreducibility of C and its action upon A and B be tested?

6.13.9 Ethical Constraints

Which ethical constraints should govern the promotion, maintenance, or dissolution of a third subjectivity? How can the consent, autonomy, and possibility of withdrawal of the originating subjectivities be protected?

6.13.10 Relation to Physical Reality

How does a third subjectivity depend upon physical processes, and in what sense might it be irreducible to physical description? How should ontological reality be distinguished from physical independence?

Answers to these questions must be pursued by distinguishing conceptual analysis, formalization, operationalization, and empirical testing, rather than by expanding the definition of SIO without constraint.

6.14 Conclusion

SIO should not be understood as a completed metaphysical system. Nor, within the comparative set examined in Chapter 4, can it be identified as a merely terminological restatement of any single prior theory.

SIO is a structured ontological proposal centered on the claim that an irreducible further subjectivity may be constituted through the intersection of differentiated subjectivities and may in turn reconstitute the subjectivities from which it arose.

This proposal permits different questions to be posed concerning subjectivity and objectivity, relations among subjects, the ontological status of relation, emergence, unity and multiplicity, individuality, temporality, knowledge, and ethical relations with others.

Its philosophical possibility does not, however, mean that SIO has already been established. Open problems remain concerning the individuation, persistence, subjectivity, temporal structure, and relation to physical reality of the generated third subjectivity.

The philosophical significance of SIO therefore depends on whether its structure can be rendered conceptually coherent, formally precise, and empirically discriminable from alternative explanations.

The research program outlined in this chapter distinguishes the conceptual, formal, and empirical tasks required for that purpose. The next step is to decompose these tasks into individually testable research questions and determine where SIO possesses explanatory power and where it requires revision or rejection.

7 Conclusion

7.1 Achievements of This Study

This paper has defined Subjectivity Intersection Ontology (SIO) conceptually, examined its historical position through an explicit comparative methodology, and identified the tasks required for its further philosophical, formal, and empirical development.

Chapter 2 defined the ontological structure of SIO in its own terms, without reducing it to an established philosophical vocabulary. In SIO, subjectivity is defined as perspective. Relative Subjectivity is differentiated through the projection of Absolute Subjectivity, while Intersection Subjectivity emerges in the interval between them. The canonical operational form through which this ontological prototype may be expressed in relation to multiple Relative Subjectivities is:

$$AB \rightarrow C \rightarrow AB.$$

In this form, a third subjectivity, C, is constituted through the intersection of differentiated subjectivities A and B, and C acts back upon the subjectivities from which it arose. The canonical operational form does not replace the ontological prototype; it provides a form through which the development of that prototype may be described.

Chapter 3 defined the methodology through which SIO could be compared with other ontologies. It distinguished vocabulary, conceptual, structural, ontological, operational, and empirical levels of comparison, thereby establishing that terminological correspondence cannot by itself demonstrate theoretical identity. It then introduced N1–N5 as independent

structural criteria and N6 as the conjunction condition assessing whether those criteria are integrated within a single general ontology. This methodology was presented not as a scale for ranking philosophical value, but as a framework for evaluating criterion-specific structural correspondence with SIO.

Chapter 4 applied this methodology consistently to twenty-one comparison targets. For each target, textual evidence, interpretive reconstruction, and structural assessment were distinguished, and N1–N6 were evaluated according to four categories: clear satisfaction, partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction, non-satisfaction, and insufficient evidence. The historical significance, religious truth, philosophical superiority, and possible influence upon SIO of the theories examined were outside the scope of these assessments.

Chapter 5 integrated the assessments established in Chapter 4 without modifying them. The analysis showed that individual structures relevant to SIO are distributed across multiple traditions and that some targets exhibit significant partial correspondence across several criteria. No target in the examined comparative set, however, clearly satisfied all of N1–N5 and integrated them within a single general ontology, as required for clear satisfaction of N6. This result was formulated in Proposition 5.1 as the absence of clear structural equivalence within the comparative set.

Chapter 6 examined the philosophical implications and research scope of SIO without deriving its truth or absolute novelty from the comparative findings. It considered the conceptual implications of SIO for subjectivity and objectivity, intersubjectivity, relation, emergence, unity and multiplicity, individuation, temporality, causality, epistemology, and ethics. It also distinguished ontological claims, formal hypotheses, operational indicators, and empirical evidence, and identified the individuation, formalization, empirical discriminability, and failure conditions of third subjectivity as principal tasks for future research.

7.2 Central Conclusion

The central structure that characterizes SIO in this paper does not consist in asserting triadity, relationality, emergence, or interaction separately. It consists in integrating, as a general ontology, a structure in which an irreducible third subjectivity is constituted through the constitutive intersection of differentiated subjectivities and subsequently reconstitutes the subjectivities from which it arose.

The analyses in Chapters 4 and 5 do not show that the elements composing this structure lack historical precedents. Elements corresponding to the ontological fundamentality of subjectivity, differentiation, relational constitution, third terms, generation, reconstitution, and general theoretical scope appear in different forms across multiple traditions examined in this study. Kashmir Śaivism, Schelling, Hegel, and Nishida, moreover, exhibit partial or interpretation-dependent satisfaction of N6.

The conclusion of this paper is therefore not that SIO has no points of correspondence with previous theories. Rather, individual correspondences are distributed across multiple targets, while none of the twenty-one comparison targets examined here clearly exhibits the complete conjunction of N1–N6.

On the basis of this result, SIO cannot, within the examined comparative set, be identified as a merely terminological restatement of any one of the theories considered. This limited

distinguishability neither demonstrates complete structural non-equivalence between SIO and the comparison targets nor establishes the absolute historical novelty of SIO.

7.3 What This Study Has Not Established and Its Methodological Limitations

This study has not demonstrated the absolute novelty of SIO or its chronological priority within the history of thought. The historical review was restricted to major comparison targets and did not encompass every philosophical, religious, mystical, or scientific tradition. Additional traditions, including Chinese philosophy, Islamic philosophy, Jewish philosophy, and mystical thought, may contain structures warranting further examination.

Nor has this study demonstrated the truth of SIO, its superiority to other ontologies, or the empirical reality of third subjectivity. Historical distinguishability does not entail ontological validity. Likewise, the possibility of presenting a conceptually coherent form does not demonstrate that a corresponding existent is constituted in reality.

This paper has not adopted any particular mathematical model or physical theory as a definitive formalization of SIO. It has also not established specific empirical hypotheses concerning electroencephalography, inter-brain interaction, human–artificial-intelligence interaction, multi-agent systems, or quantum systems. These remain possible domains of application or future hypotheses rather than empirical facts entailed directly by the ontological definition of SIO.

The assessments in Chapter 4 depend upon the selected primary sources, translations, secondary literature, and interpretive reconstructions. Different selections or interpretations may justify revisions to particular N-criterion assessments. The comparative methodology is intended not to eliminate such disagreement, but to identify whether it arises at the level of textual evidence, interpretation, or structural assessment.

N1–N6 are not presented as a universal and final taxonomy for evaluating every ontology. They are SIO-relative criteria designed to examine the extent to which comparison targets correspond structurally to SIO as defined in this paper. The comparative methodology adopted here may itself remain subject to further philosophical and methodological examination. The distinction among levels of comparison, the independence of the individual criteria, the assessment categories, and the conjunction rule governing N6 should all remain open to reevaluation in light of additional comparative cases and critical analysis.

Proposition 5.1 must therefore be understood as a result relative to the specified comparative set, evaluative criteria, and interpretations of the literature. Its scope is limited to the absence of a clearly established structural equivalent among the targets examined; it cannot be treated as a universal demonstration of absence across the history of thought.

7.4 Final Position

SIO should accordingly be understood as a structurally distinguishable yet unfinished ontological research program. Its central proposal is that differentiated subjectivities may intersect so as to constitute a further subjectivity irreducible to either of them, and that this generated subjectivity may in turn reconstitute the subjectivities from which it arose.

This paper has defined that proposal without reducing it to any single existing theory, articulated it as a structure capable of systematic comparison, and clarified its position within

a delimited historical comparative set. Historical distinctness, however, does not establish ontological validity. Whether SIO can become a viable ontology depends not only upon its historical position, but also upon its conceptual coherence, formal precision, and empirical discriminability.

What this study provides, therefore, is neither the completion nor the confirmation of SIO, but a transparent foundation for the future systematic examination of its conceptual coherence, formalizability, and empirical discriminability. This foundation is not intended to preserve the claims of SIO unconditionally, but to establish a research program capable of clarifying the conditions under which those claims should be refined, tested, revised, or rejected.

A Open Research Methodology and Repository Documentation

A.1 Purpose

This appendix explains the research process through which the present manuscript on Subjectivity Intersection Ontology (SIO) was drafted, revised, and made publicly available.

The comparative methodology, N1–N6, and the structural assessment procedure are defined in Chapter 3 and are not restated here. This appendix concerns version control, the distinction between working drafts and the current manuscript, the use of public issues to document research questions, and the use of AI-assisted tools.

The public repository is not evidence supporting the conclusions of this paper. It is a record of the research process.

A.2 Open Development

The manuscript was developed not as a single document disclosed only upon completion, but as a version-controlled work with a recorded history of change. Initial definitions, historical comparisons, evaluation criteria, chapter drafts, and the integrated manuscript were documented incrementally in a public repository.

This history allows readers to trace how initial definitions, the comparative methodology, and individual assessments were revised before reaching their current form.

The public record does not imply that the comparative criteria were preregistered before the research began. It shows that the methodology itself underwent examination and revision and that its current definition is stated explicitly in the manuscript.

A.3 Repository Structure

This study used GitHub to make the manuscript, drafts, comparative materials, and research questions publicly available under version control. The research repository is available at:

<https://github.com/SIEL-Research/Subjectivity-Intersection-Ontology>

The repository distinguishes the current integrated manuscript from materials belonging to its development.

Location	Contents	Status
<code>manuscript/</code>	Abstract, Chapters 1–7, and Appendix A	Current author-approved manuscript
<code>drafts/</code> <code>comparisons/</code>	Chapter drafts, initial definitions, and earlier structures Initial comparisons of individual theories	Working history and source archive Supplementary materials documenting the development of the historical comparison
<code>review/</code>	Search strategies, selection criteria, comparison matrices, and reviews of potential weaknesses	Records of methodological development and internal audit
Public issues	Comparison candidates, possible counterexamples, unresolved questions, and revision tasks	Public record of research questions and tasks
Revision history	Content and sequence of file changes	Version history and provenance information

Table 11. Structure and status of materials in the public research repository.

For the current content of the paper, `manuscript/` is authoritative. Materials in `drafts/`, `comparisons/`, `review/`, and the public issues may contain definitions, methods, or provi-

sional assessments that were subsequently revised or withdrawn. They do not replace the final manuscript; they preserve its developmental history.

The repository serves as a supplementary record through which the provenance of individual judgments may be examined.

A.4 AI Assistance and Authorial Responsibility

AI-assisted tools were used during the development of this manuscript for drafting, Japanese–English translation, stylistic editing, organization of chapter structure, terminology consistency checks, and repository integration.

Outputs from AI-assisted tools were not treated as primary sources, specialist scholarship, or independent evidence for philosophical or historical claims. The ontological definition of SIO, the selection of comparison targets, the final meanings of N1–N6, the individual assessments, the limits placed upon the claims, and the final wording were reviewed and approved by the author.

AI assistance does not transfer authorial responsibility. Responsibility for the accuracy of the sources, historical interpretations, comparative assessments, translations, and final manuscript remains with the author. If the journal of submission requires a separate disclosure of AI use, an additional statement will be provided in accordance with that policy.

A.5 Public Review and Formal Peer Review

Public issues and the revision history were used to document comparison candidates, possible counterexamples, methodological questions, and revision tasks. The existence of an issue, the number of comments it receives, or its open or closed status does not constitute scholarly agreement or peer-review approval.

Public discussion does not replace formal peer review. Its function is to make the development of the manuscript traceable and to allow readers or reviewers to examine the provenance of particular judgments when necessary. Public review provides transparency concerning the research process; formal peer review provides a distinct process of expert and institutional evaluation.

A.6 Limits of Transparency

Version control makes it possible to retrieve a particular version of the manuscript, compare passages before and after revision, and inspect the consistency among the criteria in Chapter 3, the assessments in Chapter 4, and the integrated results in Chapter 5. Transparency, however, does not guarantee correctness. Researchers consulting the same materials may reach different interpretations or structural assessments.

Because the `main` branch is updated over time, it is not an immutable object of citation. Any critique or citation of a specific version should identify a complete commit SHA, release tag, or permanently archived version.

Repository timestamps and revision history establish the order of documentation within this repository. They do not demonstrate intellectual priority, independent discovery, or absolute historical novelty.

A.7 Academic Status

The research repository preserves the distinction between the current manuscript and earlier versions, the revision history leading from drafts to the integrated manuscript, comparative materials, public issues, and unresolved questions. These records support the provenance, transparency, and auditability of the research process.

The repository is not independent evidence for the ontological validity of SIO, its structural distinguishability within the examined historical comparison set, or the empirical reality of third subjectivity. The conclusions of this paper must be evaluated on the basis of the definitions, primary sources, interpretations, comparative methodology, and limitations presented in the main text.

The purpose of this appendix is not to strengthen the case for the validity of SIO, but to make the research process underlying the manuscript publicly traceable and auditable. The transparency documented here should be distinguished from the philosophical claims advanced in the main text.

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